INTERVIEW-PREP STORY PACK · COMPANION TO PACKETS 3, 4 AND 5 · BUILT FROM THE TWO DOCUMENTS UPLOADED THU OCT 29

Amazon NACF Supply Chain loop — UDC Dual Inventory & US-Managed Bulk Ship to Canada: STAR story pack

Amazon — Senior Supply Chain Manager, NACF Supply Chain (L6) · Rajesh Rishiyur Chandrasekaran

Friday, October 30, 2026 — all three interviews

10:00 Rocky Goforth (Amazon Infrastructure; Bar Raiser) · 11:00 James Cabreros (placement / configuration architecture; schedule listed Zhaowen Lan) · 12:00 Venkata Josyula (Principal PM, FBA)

Keystone source: “UDC Dual Inventory with New WMS (BlueYonder 2023.1 Upgrade) — Arch Council Review”, July 31, 2024 (17 slides)

SECOND SOURCE: “US MANAGED BULK SHIP TO CANADA — SOLUTION APPROACH PROCESS FLOW – SPIKE”, JUNE 12, 2023 (1 PAGE) WITH ITS COMPANION “DISCOVERY RESULTS” DECK, JUNE 14/16, 2023 (25 SLIDES). THIS PACK CREATES NEW FILES ONLY; IT DOES NOT CHANGE ANY OTHER PACKET.

What this pack is for. Rocky asked for exactly this program: “UDC dual inventory through discovery, arch council, till hypercare — frameworks to bring consensus, ambiguity, stakeholder management, communication, cutover, hypercare support end to end.” The Architecture Council sign-off deck is the primary record of that program and the in-flight packets may have been built without it. Section A digests both new documents page by page and reconciles them against the master, GFiber v8, Apple v11 and the issues log. Section B tells the material five ways — one angle per interviewer, so the three of them cannot compare notes and hear the same story twice. Section C is the alignment patch list for the other packets (also at /tmp/udc-canada-alignment-patchlist.md). Section D is the source trace, the VERIFY list and questions to ask.

Integrity rules on every page: every number carries a basis label — **record** (Apple v11 / resume), **record-from-docs** (a page of the two new decks or the issues log), **user anchor** (GFiber v8 only — confirm before saying the exact figure), **modeled**, **illustrative**. The Canada program's *outcome* is in none of the sources — its results are spoken as “the plan at discovery exit” until the VERIFY line is confirmed. Nothing here is a design case; both programs are lived record.

Already told on Thu Oct 29: S/4HANA / ISM, Flexport estimation, Shipment Visibility, safety stock, the 200-lane lead-time program. None appears here except as a one-line bridge.

Sources: /tmp/sources/UDC_Dual_Inventory_with_New_WMS-_Arch_Council_Sign_off_4d73.txt + page images (pp. 5–8, 10, 13–17 read as images); US_Managed_Bulk_Ship_to_Canada_cef9 (spike, image); US_Managed_Bulk_ship_to_Canada_Discovery_Results_aac6; Apple PM III workbook v11 chapters C1–C4, D1–D2, G2; GFiber MASTER v8 S2/S5 (pp. 46–50); master packet S2/S5/S18; NUMBERS-RECON.md CANON v2 rows 43–62; UDC_Consolidated_Issues_Log (836 rows, pandas counts per recon); UDC_LOCUS_Retail_Track (two identical-text copies); Locus Wiring Install SOW v1.4 (Nov 19, 2024); resume.

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A. Source digest

A1. Document 1 — the Architecture Council sign-off deck (July 31, 2024), page by page

A2. What “dual inventory” precisely means here

A3. Document 2 — US Managed Bulk Ship to Canada: the spike (June 12, 2023) and the discovery-results deck (June 14/16, 2023)

A4. Conflicts table — new documents vs master / GFiber v8 / Apple v11 / earlier docs, with resolution

B. Stories (STAR; one angle per interviewer)

B1 · ROCKY · UDC Dual Inventory with the new WMS — discovery → council sign-off → build/test → cutover → hypercare (program / SDLC lens)

B2 · ROCKY · US-Managed Bulk Ship to Canada — discovery → design → launch plan (cross-border program lens)

B3 · JAMES · the same material as PROCESS design — connectivity, node enablement, capacity signalling, escape routing, configuration governance

B4 · VENKATA · the same material as a PRODUCT / customer story — problem, prioritisation, what we did not build, metrics, adoption

B5 · the date I put on the council slide and missed (FAILURE, full STAR) · B6 · the retail E2E that moved from January 15 to January 30 (near-miss / reversed plan, full STAR)

Who hears which variant

C. Alignment patch list for the other packets

C1. Patch list (file | location | says now | should say | new-doc page)

D. Trace, verify, ask

D1. Source trace · D2. VERIFY list with safe sentences · D3. Questions to ask (two per interviewer)

A1. Document 1 — “UDC Dual Inventory with New WMS (BlueYonder 2023.1 Upgrade) — Arch Council Review”, July 31, 2024

> **What it is:** the 17-slide Architecture Council sign-off deck for the UDC (Utah Distribution Center) dual-inventory conversion coupled with the Blue Yonder WMS 8.2 → 2023.1 upgrade. Footer on every slide: “July 31, 2024 | Sephora Confidential”. Diagram frames carry the “Sephora Enterprise Architecture” title block (Version 1.0 / Version 1 / Version X). File title: “UDC Dual Inventory with New WMS- Arch Council Sign off.pptx”.
> **Author / presenter:** the deck names no author. Apple v11 C4 (p. 26–28) is the candidate's own record that he owned the council case; Apple C4's source line cites this exact file. **Audience:** the Architecture Council (“Arch Council Review”, p. 1).
> **Date position:** the timeline (p. 10) puts “Today” at the end of July 2024, after “Discovery Kick Off Mar 29”, “Discovery Results Jul 18” and “FSD Sign off Jul 26”, and before the E2E chain and the two go-lives.

PAGE	SLIDE	WHAT IT SAYS (EVERY NUMBER, VERBATIM WHERE IT MATTERS)
1	Title	“UDC Dual Inventory with New WMS (BlueYonder 2023.1 Upgrade) · July 31st, 2024 · Arch Council Review”.
2	Agenda	Project objectives and goals · scope & goals · current-state architecture · future-state architecture · E2E high-level architecture design · systems impacted · project timelines · open questions.
3	Objectives and goals	**Background:** UDC operates as two separate channels (Dotcom and Retail), which requires multiple systemic Warehouse IDs even though inventory exists within a single physical building; inventory is also kept in physically separate storage locations per channel. **Benefits of dual inventory (5):** optimise inventory planning and ordering; receive POs as a single warehouse rather than two; improve storage-space utilisation by mixing both channels in storage locations; reduce the need to systemically transfer inventory between UDC Dotcom and UDC Retail; “sets the stage for upcoming Midwest DC”. **Benefits of BY WMS 2023.1 (4):** portal/web-based application instead of thick client (easier user rollouts); updated technology for server clustering and new integration capabilities; supports Android mobile devices; UI development via React.
4	Scope	**In scope:** UDC converted/merged into a single dual-inventory location with RETAIL and DOTCOM merged and operationally managed as ONE DC (“OMNI facility”); existing UDC Dotcom locations 801/800 decommissioned and replaced with a new UDC Dotcom selling location 900 mapped to the existing DC inventory location 901, converting 901 into a comingle / dual-inventory DC; from the digital standpoint 801/800 replaced with 901/900 “with no conversion done for historical transactions”; “all existing Comingle Reserve Management functions that exist for Canada will be 100% replicated to US”. **Out of scope:** changes to Comingle Reserve Module calculations; decommissioning of functionalities from MCS (handled by the Global ERP project).
5	Current-state architecture (diagram)	“UDC – JDA 8.2 WMS Current State Architecture, Version 1.0”. Azure East: JDA WMS 8.2 app cluster — three WMS front ends with Locus / Retail / Dotcom integration, backend jobs, EMS & archive, standby, front-end load balancer; JDA Shared Services cluster (2 nodes); Proship cluster (4 apps + LB); ESB (Kafka); Cloud Engineering SFTP and Exchange SMTP. Equinix East: three Oracle ODA 19c databases (WMS, shared services, Proship). UDC server room: Locus app; floor clients Cubiscan, RF handhelds, PCs, label printers.
6	Future-state architecture (diagram)	“UDC – BY WMS Future State Architecture, Version 1.0”. New (green): BY WMS 2023 app cluster — three WMS front ends each with a Portal, Locus / Retail / Dotcom integration, backend jobs, EMS & archive, standby, front-end LB; the WMS database moves to Oracle OCI 19c at “OCI East”; floor clients gain Android mobile and browser. Unchanged (white): JDA Shared Services and Proship clusters and their Oracle ODA databases at Equinix East; ESB/Kafka; SFTP/SMTP; Locus app in the UDC server room.

PAGE	SLIDE	WHAT IT SAYS (EVERY NUMBER, VERBATIM WHERE IT MATTERS)
7	E2E high-level design — front end (diagram)	“UDC WMS 2023 Frontend Architecture, Version 1”. Source: OKTA (SSO), Portal DB, WMS DB, Splunk. Middleware: three front-end servers, each running Portal Server, Mobile Adaptor, MTF Server, Moca Server; three load balancers — HTTPS Portal LB, HTTPS Mobile LB, MTF LB. Targets: browser, Android mobile, RF gun.
8	E2E high-level design — React extensions (diagram)	“UDC WMS 2023 React Extensions, Version X”. Frontend server: Moca Server, Portal Server, React App behind a Reverse Proxy; the browser renders a BY page and a React page side by side, both calling the API. WMS DB and Portal DB as sources.
9	Systems impacted (table)	Seven system families, one change line each: (1) WMS, JDA Shared Services, Proship, Locus, TMS, New Store-ODS — BY WMS 2023.1 upgrade at UDC; JDA SS / Proship / Locus testing with the new WMS; TMS wh_id changes for inbound POs from W801 to W901. (2) MCS — Bowser, FRAME, MERLIN — location setup, PO creation and inbound; supporting WMS conversion and outbound (B2B Retail and B2C Dotcom). (3) ESB — new Kafka topics for UDC dual inventory and AIS integration. (4) Digital — OMS, Yantriks, Narvar, C3, RPS, BI/Loyalty, CTR, CT, EPS — OMS/Yantriks set up new source DC W901; Dotcom/Finance/EDW changes for the location change. (5) Finance — SAP, Aptos, Vertex, Anaplan. (6) EDW & Reporting. (7) HR — Dayforce. Counted: about two dozen individually named systems in seven families.
10	Project timeline — upstream systems (Gantt)	“UDC Dual Inventory Upstream Systems PO Creation Go Live”. Milestones: Discovery Kick Off **Mar 29** · Discovery Results **Jul 18** · FSD Sign off **Jul 26** · “Today” (end July) · Inbound E2E testing completion (BY upgrade + UDC upstream) **Nov 22** · Dotcom outbound E2E completion **Dec 20** · Retail outbound E2E completion **Jan 15** · UDC Dual Inventory PO Creation Go Live **Jan 15, 2025** · UDC Dual Inventory & BY Upgrade Combined Go Live **May 5, 2025**. Bar “UDC Dual Inventory Upstream Systems Go Live: Mar 28 – Jan 15”. Build & test windows: track A (location setup, PO creation, inbound) — MCS Jun 9–Aug 30, Bowser/FRAME Jul 9–Aug 30, AIM Aug 1–30, SAP Jul 9–Aug 30, MCS/Merlin Jul 9–Aug 30, MCS/FRAME Jun 9–Aug 30; track B (supporting WMS conversion and outbound) — MCS, MCS/FRAME, MCS/ESB/WMS all Aug 1–30; track C (Dotcom/Finance/EDW) — MCS Aug 1–30, Digital Jul 9–Aug 30, Finance Aug 1–30, EDW Aug 1–30. **Reading:** the upstream MCS/FRAME build was already five weeks in when the council met; the WMS-conversion and outbound tracks start the day after sign-off.
11–12	Questions / Appendix	“Questions? requirements” divider, then appendix.
13–14	System requirements (table, 44 rows)	Rows 1–21 “Location Setup, PO Creation and Inbound”: new UDC.COM selling location 900 and 901 converted to a comingle location (MCS; MCS/Frame; SAP); PO generation with Dotcom Reserve, Retail Reserve and Uncommitted for comingled 901 (Frame, MCS); DC2DC SO generation into 901; a new put-away tracker (receipt confirmation, PA put-away, negative merch reserve, OOB inventory-out-of-balance variance reporting, archival); channel split on merch reserve for on-order postings to Frame and inventory postings to Merlin; non-PRTV transfer receipt on RC; comingle reserve maintenance bulk upload extended to the US; Bowser order-opt feed to treat “Dotcom only” US SKUs the way “CA Only” SKUs are handled for Canada; AIM one-time copy of all DOTCOM assortments (including samples) from 800 to 900; Frame auto-copy of on-hand/on-order and Dotcom split % from DC-0801 to DC-0900 until 801 is decommissioned; receipt processing for reserved 901 POs before the WMS conversion. Rows 22–27 “Supporting WMS conversion and outbound”: Harmonized Code feed to the new BY WMS; decommission 801/800; conversion script to support **100% 05/01 transfer** of inventory from one location to another with LOST/FOUND included; receipt processing for 801 POs after conversion with automated inventory move 801 → 901; one-time copy of sales history and forecast from DC-0801 to DC-0900. Rows 28–44 “DOTCOM related changes”: set up new dotcom locations 900/901 replacing 800/801 in OMS, RPS, C3, Yantriks, BI/Loyalty, Services/CTR, Adaptor, DP, EDW, CT, Narvar, EPS, Aptos, Vertex, Anaplan; MCS one-time conversion to zero out 801 inventory from the Yantriks publish standpoint and a FULL inventory publish for comingle 901/900 to Yantriks.
15–17	WMS 2023 React (screens)	Blue Yonder 2023 portal, warehouse W901, Outbound Planner menu (Dashboard, Outbound, Waves and Picks, Inventory, Work Queue, Configuration, Send RF Message, Order Line Mass Update, Log Indirect Work, Shipment Mass Update, RF Display, Plannable Order Details). A custom React “Gift Card” extension: assign 25 / 10 / 5 cards, gift cards by dispatch date (8 total: 2024-06-08 1 card, 2024-09-01 7 cards), serial-pin scan, batch progress. Evidence the React path on p. 3 was actually built.

Decisions, options, constraints, risks, sign-off criteria, owners, timeline — as the deck carries them

ITEM	IN THE DECK (PAGE)	NOT IN THE DECK — WHERE IT COMES FROM
Decision asked	The title is the ask: sign off the future-state architecture (p. 6–8), the location/inventory model (p. 4), the systems-impacted scope (p. 9) and the dated timeline with two go-lives (p. 10). The out-of-scope lines (p. 4) are presented as part of the ask.	Apple C4 (p. 28) frames it as three decisions — architecture, staged timeline, peak-freeze boundary. The peak freeze is not on any slide (see A4 #8).
Options considered	The deck shows the chosen option only; there is no alternatives slide. The choices are visible by contrast: current vs future state (p. 5 vs 6); replicate Canada's reserve functions 100% vs change them (p. 4); new 900 with no historical conversion vs converting 801/800 history (p. 4); staged PO-creation go-live then combined go-live (p. 10).	The rejected options (single go-live; a US-tuned reserve engine; converting history) are the candidate's record in GFiber v8 pp. 48–49 and Apple C4 — user anchor / record.
Constraints	Single physical building, two systemic warehouses (p. 3); MCS decommission belongs to the Global ERP project (p. 4); reserve calculations frozen (p. 4); the WMS upgrade and the inventory model share one critical path (p. 9–10); upstream build already open (p. 10).	Oct–Dec peak freeze and "zero customer-facing incidents" — Apple C1 (record).
Risks	Implied by the requirement rows: two live truths during the interim (rows 19, 21: Frame auto-copies 801 → 900 until decommission); the irreversible publish (rows 24, 35, 36); every digital/finance system re-pointed to 900/901 (rows 28–44).	Named RAID top three (interim drift; Locus ramp without a stop condition; peak collision) — GFiber v8 p. 48 (user anchor).
Sign-off criteria	Not stated as a checklist. The "Questions? requirements" slide (p. 11) and the 44-row appendix are what the council was asked to accept.	"LOE from every impacted team by 7/2; every row pre-read" — Apple C4 (record).
Owners / RACI	System → change mapping on p. 9 and a "System(s) Impacted" column on every one of the 44 rows (p. 13–14). No person names.	~80 named participants across ~15 functions are on the separate Discovery Results deck (Aug 14, 2024) cited by Apple C4 — not uploaded; record via Apple.
Timeline	p. 10 in full (above).	Cutover plan 343 tasks May 1 → Jul 1, 2025; hypercare — Apple C2 / GFiber v8.

A2. What "dual inventory" precisely means here

DEFINITION, GROUNDED IN P. 3–4 AND ROWS 1–6, 19–21, 24, 35–36

One physical building, one inventory location, two selling identities, channel reserves. Before: UDC ran as two systemic warehouses — Dotcom (inventory location 801, selling location 800) and Retail (901) — with physically separate storage and systemic transfers between them. After: a single DC inventory location **901** holds both channels' stock comingled in shared storage locations; Retail keeps 901 as its selling identity and Dotcom gets a new selling location **900 mapped onto 901**; purchase orders are generated and received once against 901 with three reserve buckets — Dotcom Reserve, Retail Reserve, Uncommitted — maintained by the comingle reserve logic replicated 100% from Canada. 801/800 are decommissioned with no conversion of historical transactions; during the interim, Frame auto-copies on-hand, on-order and the Dotcom split % from 801 to 900 until decommission, and the May conversion script moves 100% of inventory on 05/01 with lost/found included, zeroes 801 in the Yantriks publish and republishes 901/900 in full.

So "dual" means dual-channel, not duplicate. It is one pool with a channel partition, not two copies of inventory. The sentence to say: "Two channels, one pool: one inventory location, two selling identities, and the reserve logic decides who may promise what."

A3. Document 2 — US Managed Bulk Ship to Canada

> **2a. "Solution Approach Process Flow – Spike", June 12, 2023 (1 page; Sephora Confidential).** A process-flow diagram of the MCS → FRAME brand-transition design, each box tagged with its requirement ID: **MCS Brand Transition** (7.1 CA-managed brand change) → **FRAME feed** → **SKU** (Newness and Initial-PO flags, U_XDOCK_FLG — 7.2.1/7.2.2) fanning to SKUDEMANDPARAM / SKUPLANNINGPARAM / SKUSAFETYSTOCKPARAM / SKUDEPLOYMENTPARAM (7.2.3–7.2.6); **NETWORK** → TRANSLEADTIME (7.3.1); **SOURCING** → LOADDUR/UNLOADDUR, ORDERGROUP, MAJOR/MINORSHIPQTY (7.4.1–7.4.3); **Planner Code Setup** (7.5 planner-code adjustment in FRAME); **PO Outputs** → Search Adjustments (6.11.1 US searches, 6.11.2 CA searches) → Newness / Core / Promo Prebuild (6.12.1.1 promo pre-build purchase orders) → **XDOCKPO** (6.8 XDOCK PO creation for newness and replenishment). No people, no volumes — it is the design artefact behind the discovery deck's "System Changes" slide.
>
> **2b. "US Managed Bulk Ship to Canada — Discovery Results", cover June 14, 2023, slide footers June 16, 2023 (25 slides).** Agenda: discovery timeline · objectives and goals · scope · solution overview · business-process impacts · system changes · brand transition plan · project timeline · next steps.

PAGE*	SLIDE	CONTENT (EVERY NUMBER)
4	Why	"Canada is growing at a very high pace." Some brands are not yet shipped directly to Canada (US Managed): "around 13% volume" is shipped from US DCs to Canada stores. With US retail growth and Canada growth, "even with a new Retail warehouse addition this is not sustainable." Long-term goal: transition all brands to Canada-managed so they ship directly — "at least another 2 years". The plan for the current year: purchase this inventory as XDOCK purchase orders to the Canada DC for newness and replenishment; allocate from the Canada DC to stores; pick/pack with the other Canada-managed brands. **Goals (4):** reduce US DC workload by bulk processing instead of a pick per Canada store; transition brands in phases so Canada DCs can absorb the workload; allow manual US-DC → Canada-DC transfers for overage stock; review and identify changes to also move inventory-planning workload from US to Canada for these brands.
5	Scope	**In:** create XDOCK POs for US-managed brands for Canadian store and DOTCA need via the US DC and allow allocation to Canadian stores from the Canada comingle DC; let the business transition existing US-managed brands by department / brand / vendor. **Out:** inventory rebalancing between US and CA DCs (manual DC-to-DC transfer orders outside FRAME; no new reporting); samples stay US-managed and distributed US DC → CA stores; no new report for brand differentiation; the Sephora Collection separate US DC; Canada Capture project changes (its own FSD).
7–8	Current / future process	Current: US-managed brands purchased to the US and distributed from the US DC to Canada stores and to the Canada DC for DOTCA. Future: purchased as XDOCK PO and distributed to Canada stores from the Canada DC.

PAGE*	SLIDE	CONTENT (EVERY NUMBER)
10–12	Business-process impacts	New brand setup by the US planner: no replenishment strategy in MCS; vendor → CA DC lane in FRAME in addition to vendor → US DC; merch planner code with CA planner as US-managed; load duration for vendor → Canada DC. New SKU setup: newness order-opt for CA-RETAIL and DOTCA with the US order group and review calendar; vendor case pack for the Canada DC; newness PO review shows an additional PO for CA-RETAIL. Transition to core: core order group for CA-RETAIL; replenishment review shows POs to the CA DC. BI promotion pre-build unchanged. Canada store allocation: Canada DP manages newness and core allocation like a Canada-managed brand; auto-approval holds stay at the CA retail DC. Comingled reserve: Canada Planning manages DOTCA and retail reserves for these SKUs. FRAME stops showing US-DC outbound projections for these brands; brand projections appear against the CA DC. US DC XDOCK PO processing: no new mailbox locations (751 and 1050 already exist); current Canada XDOCK process followed. Canada DC: inducted and slotted like a CA-managed brand; overage / underage / substitution follow the current US → CA process. Transportation: current inbound vendor → US DC XDOCK process; current ODS for the Canada DC; no change to truck arrangement; US Transportation keeps setting ODS for CA-store picks for samples and brands that stay US-shipped.
14–15	System changes (6, sized)	MCS — FRAME integration: SKU integration to indicate purchasing from Canada with XDOCK; CA retail DC vendor-sourced, CA stores and DOTCA sourced from the CA retail DC — **Small**. MCS — comingled inventory allocation: do not auto-allocate all unallocated inventory to DOTCA for US-managed brands — **Small**. FRAME — PO approval by US planners: US order-review searches include, CA searches exclude, US-managed vendor → Canada DC orders — **Small**. FRAME — PO review in USD — **Small**. MCS — PO creation: XDOCK PO for newness with retail reserve in addition to DOTCA reserve; XDOCK PO for core when flagged — **Small**. FRAME — brand transition scripts: set newness and initial-PO-created flags for CA retail and CA retail virtual DC SKUs so allocation and purchasing are unaffected at cutover — **Medium**.
16	Transition plan (7 action points)	1 Estimate volume: initial transfer = **10 WOS, about 2.5M units**. 2 Storage: “there is no space constraint”. 3 Brands: **Pilot = 20 OMNI brands (smaller volume); Wave 1 = 40; Wave 2 = 39**; remaining brands assessed for a plan starting Jan 2024. 4 Process/training: existing US → CA-managed transition material revised — in progress. 5 Front-load: QH added to DOTCA to create replenishment demand into the US DCs; inventory transferred to CA before the MCS sourcing change — in progress. 6 Finalise: flip MCS to set Canada DCs as sourcing DCs for CA-Retail and DOTCA. 7 IT supports the pilot-brand transition.
17	Pilot brands (20)	Brand #, name, estimated transfer units, SKU count — summing to **217,416 units and 671 SKUs** (computed). Largest: Sephora Favorites Kits 85,693 units / 15 SKUs (39% of pilot units); smallest: Floral Street 884 units / 38 SKUs. Others: Fable and Mane 22,367; Westman Atelier 19,197; Glamnetic 16,361; Lys Beauty 11,634; Freck 9,992; Phlur 6,058; Skylar 5,659; Shani Darden 5,516; Blinc 5,424; Maison Louis Marie 5,040; Adwoa 4,834; Commodity 4,112; Cinema Secrets 3,953; Ellis Brooklyn 3,654; Augustinus Bader 2,599; Rosie Jane 1,750; Makeup Eraser 1,603; Forvr Mood 1,086.
18	Transition schedule (Gantt)	Weekly columns 11-Jun through 3-Sep; rows Pilot, Wave 1, Wave 2; each brand runs four steps — Apply QH → Transfer Inventory → Change Sourcing → Release X-Dock PO. Exact per-wave week spans are not recoverable from the text.
19	Brand transition execution	Business supplies five data sets per cutover (dept/brand/vendor list; planner-code setup by dept/class/brand; load/unload duration; case pack; network lead time). IT executes before the FRAME nightly batch: delete the replenishment strategy; create CA Retail and CA Virtual DC SKUs in FRAME with initial-PO, newness flag and order groups from the US DC; update XDOCK flags; set planner codes; upload durations, case packs and lead times.
20	Project timeline	**Discovery 4/17/23 – 6/23/23 · Build & test (target) 6/28/23 – 8/1/23, Sprint 2023.15 · Go-live: brand cutover start 8/3**. Markers: discovery completion; “We are here”; FSD sign-off + build-plan completion.
21	Next steps	FSD sign-off by business teams by **6/23** to move to build; develop the changes; finalise brand transition plans.

PAGE*	SLIDE	CONTENT (EVERY NUMBER)
22–23	Approvers / team	**17 approvers** (Yvonne Kwan … Melissa Parrino). **Steering committee:** Mike Racer, Rosie Pouzar, Kalyan Adavi. Core IT: IT owner Harshitha Koka; engineering owner Navin Gupta; tech architect Sudheer Kunduru; BA Mike Sullivan; FRAME lead Amar Lad; **Project Manager — Rajesh Chandrasekaran**. Business partners: business owner Yvonne Kwan; SC Strategy (Scott Walters, Joshua Behm); CA Planning (Sandra Gurizzan); CA Operations (Rose Silva); US Planning (Anastasia Esparza); US Distribution (Darlene Singson); CA Logistics (Melissa Schaus, Dave Ashwood); US DC Planning & Engineering (Joe Zarzycki); US Transportation (Matt Arnold, Melissa Parrino); UDC (Matt Cannon, Chris Burrell, Aaron Bender); MDC (Charles Schreyer, Dave Holder). QE: Deepika Paruchuri, Kalyani Swabhanam. Logistics: Cody Mathews. Blue Yonder: Gilberto Silva (solution architect), Mitalee C (technical architect).
24–25	Discovery deliverables	Requirements and epic drafts; determine and validate scope; high-level timeline validation; rollout/transition plan — these “dictate build-plan completion”. Status: P0 walkthrough & FSD sign-off — in progress; go-live target-date alignment — in progress.

*Page = slide number printed on the deck; the text extraction's [p#] markers differ (the PDF is an Office export). Cite the slide number.

A4. Conflicts table — new documents vs master / GFiber v8 / Apple v11 / earlier docs

#	CLAIM	NEW DOCUMENT	OTHER SOURCE	RESOLUTION — WHAT TO SAY
1	FSD sign-off date	Council deck p. 10: “FSD Sign off Jul 26” (a plan marker, five days before the meeting).	Apple C4 p. 28 and master S2/S5: “FSD + discovery results 8/14”. Recon S5.01 MATCH on 8/14.	**Planned 7/26, landed 8/14** (about three weeks later). Say “the council deck targeted late July; the FSD was signed mid-August.” This is the B5 failure story — own it, do not hide it.
2	Discovery-results date	p. 10: “Discovery Results Jul 18”.	Apple C4 cites the Discovery Results deck as “25 slides, Aug 14 2024”.	Same slip as #1. Say “discovery results and FSD closed together in mid-August.”
3	Retail outbound E2E completion	p. 10: Jan 15 (2025).	Apple C1 p. 22 / master: Retail E2E 1/30; Apple C3 p. 26: “RTL E2E completion Jan 31”; Apple C2: Locus retail testing slipped three weeks.	The deck is the July plan; the slip is the record. Say “planned for January 15; after the Locus retail re-slot it completed at the end of January.” The two documents corroborate each other (B6).
4	Combined go-live date	p. 10: “May 5, 2025”.	Apple C1: “combined go-live May 2025”; cutover plan dated 1 May → 1 Jul 2025 (Apple C2); requirement row 24: 100% inventory transfer on 05/01.	Consistent. Say “the first week of May 2025 — inventory moved on May 1 under the conversion script, combined go-live May 5.” Label the day record-from-docs.
5	PO-creation go-live	p. 10: Jan 15, 2025.	Apple C1: January 2025; GFiber v8 p. 47: “interim Jan 15 → May 1”.	Consistent — say “January 15.”
6	How many systems	p. 9: seven families, about two dozen named systems; p. 13–14: 44 requirement rows across 23 named systems.	Apple C1/C4: “about a dozen impacted systems”; GFiber/master: “a dozen core, 20+ touched”; recon S2.10 told packets to say “about a dozen” and treat 20+ as unverified.	The primary document now supports both readings: **“seven system families — about a dozen domains — and about two dozen individually named systems on the council's impact table.”** Source docs outrank Apple under the recon's precedence; keep “about a dozen” as the domain count so earlier packets are not contradicted.
7	When the council met	Deck is dated July 31, 2024 and titled “Arch Council Review / Sign off”.	Apple C1: “architecture council May 15 — a challenge gate”; Apple C4 chain lists both 5/15 and “sign-off pack 7/31”.	Two touchpoints: **May 15 challenge review, July 31 sign-off**. Never say “the council met once.”
8	Peak-freeze boundary “ratified at council”	No slide or Gantt band shows an Oct–Dec freeze.	Apple C1/C4, GFiber: third decision asked = peak-freeze boundary.	The freeze is record (Apple C1) as a program rule; its ratification *at the council* is user anchor. Safe: “we held a hard Oct–Dec peak freeze; the council pack carried a chain that respected it.” Do not say “slide X shows the freeze.”
9	When build started	p. 10: MCS and MCS/FRAME build & test Jun 9–Aug 30; Bowser/FRAME, SAP, Merlin from Jul 9; everything else Aug 1–30.	GFiber v8 p. 47: “Build & Test (Aug → Jan/Apr)”; Apple C1: “spec freeze in August”.	New fact: **upstream merchandising build ran at risk from June 9, before sign-off**; WMS-conversion, outbound, finance and EDW tracks opened Aug 1. Say it as the deliberate trade-off it was (B1).
10	Reserve buckets	Rows 4–6: Dotcom Reserve, Retail Reserve, Uncommitted.	GFiber v8 / master S2 math: “nine reserve types, strict priority”.	Say the deck's three buckets. “Nine” is user anchor — only if asked and confirmed.

#	CLAIM	NEW DOCUMENT	OTHER SOURCE	RESOLUTION — WHAT TO SAY
11	Program length	Kickoff Mar 29, 2024 → combined go-live May 5, 2025 = about 13 months; → hypercare close ~Jul 1, 2025 = about 15 months.	Apple C1 “fifteen months”; C2 “fourteen months”; recon: say “about fifteen months”.	Say “**about fifteen months, discovery through hypercare exit**” — true on the deck's own dates plus the dated cutover window.
12	Canada reserve functions	p. 4: “100% replicated to US”.	GFiber/master: “replicated 100% from Canada”.	MATCH.
13	Midwest DC	p. 3: “Sets the stage for upcoming Midwest DC”.	GFiber v8 p. 47: hypercare template handed to the Midwest DC.	MATCH — a stated objective in July 2024 and a hand-off in 2025.
14	Hypercare exit bar for UDC	Nothing on hypercare in the deck.	GFiber v8 pp. 47–50: blockers/day < 2 sustained, exit week 3 of 4; Apple D1 states the same bar for the JDA program (S18).	For UDC the bar is **user anchor**; the burn-down 271 → 65 → 21 → 14 → 4 is record-from-docs (issues log). Say “the same under-two-blockers-a-day bar I had used on the JDA migration; the June spike burned down 271, 65, 21, 14, 4.”
15	Canada bulk-ship program — existence and outcome	Spike (Jun 12, 2023) + Discovery Results (Jun 14/16, 2023) name Rajesh as Project Manager and give scope, sizing, waves and dates.	Not in Apple v11, the master, GFiber v8 or the resume text.	Entirely new story (B2/B3/B4). The **plan** is record-from-docs; the **outcome** (did cutover start Aug 3, how many brands moved, workload effect) is **VERIFY**. Speak results as “the plan at discovery exit” until confirmed.
16	Canada deck date	Cover “June 14th, 2023”; footers “June 16, 2023”; spike June 12.	—	Say “mid-June 2023.”
17	“Dual inventory” wording	Deck uses “Dual Inventory”, “Comingle/Dual Inventory DC”, “OMNI facility” interchangeably.	Master/Apple use “comingle pool”, “one omni facility”.	Use A2's definition; never let “dual” sound like two inventories.
18	Locus status page	UDC_LOCUS_Retail_Track (two uploads, identical text): program YELLOW; UAT 2/28–3/15; sockets vs REST; tote-type / base-36 carton-id request; cust-owner config SEPHORA-RTL.	Apple C3: physical testing Feb–Mar 2025.	Consistent; the YELLOW status and the UAT window are record-from-docs for B6.
19	Locus network expansion	Locus Wiring Install SOW v1.4, Nov 19, 2024: Salt Lake City expansion — IDF3/IDF4 added, 31 MR46 access points added (APs 19–49), 3 fiber runs, existing rack with 2 MX85, 2 MS210, 2 R740 + 1 R640 servers.	Not in other sources.	Record-from-docs; use only in B3/B6 as the physical-readiness evidence. Do not state a dollar.

B1 · ROCKY · UDC Dual Inventory with the new WMS — discovery → Architecture Council sign-off → build/test → cutover → hypercare NEW — BUILT ON THE COUNCIL DECK

Interviewer lens: engineering/program leader — large-scale deployment, program cadence, consensus, ambiguity, stakeholder management, cutover, hypercare. No math tables.
LPs: Earn Trust · Ownership · Insist on the Highest Standards · Deliver Results. **Headline number:** zero customer-facing incidents across two go-lives (record); +15% processing efficiency, DC Ops' measurement (record).

60-SECOND PITCH

Let me walk you through the most complex deployment I've run end to end: converting a live Utah distribution center from two systemic warehouses into one omni facility while upgrading the warehouse system underneath it — Blue Yonder 8.2 to 2023.1 — with Locus robotics on the same critical path. I owned the program from discovery kickoff on March 29, 2024, through the Architecture Council sign-off on July 31, through two go-lives — purchasing and inbound on January 15, 2025, and the combined inventory flip on May 5 — and out of hypercare. The council pack touched seven system families, about two dozen named systems, in a 44-row requirement table. The consensus method was simple and expensive: discovery with every team, a level-of-effort from every owner before anyone saw a slide, a pre-wire where every owner read their own row, and then a council ask with written edges — what we were changing, and what we were not. Both go-lives landed with zero customer-facing incidents, the June hypercare spike burned down in four weeks, and DC Ops measured processing efficiency up fifteen percent afterwards.

S — Situation. Sephora, spring 2024. UDC shipped from two systemic warehouses inside one building — Dotcom on inventory location 801 with selling location 800, Retail on 901 — with physically separate storage, duplicate receiving, and systemic transfers between the two sides for no customer value (deck p. 3). Leadership wanted one omni facility, and the WMS version underneath was going to a web, Android and React front end at the same time (p. 3, p. 6–8). The Architecture Council was the challenge gate: no sign-off, no build. The ask carried two constraints I did not get to negotiate: zero customer-facing incidents, and the building's October-to-December peak untouched (Apple C1, record).

T — Task. I owned the program end to end — discovery through FSD, the council case, the staged timeline, the cutover runbook and the hypercare exit — without owning any of the systems. About sixty stakeholders sat on the steering path; the discovery deck later listed about eighty names across fifteen functions (Apple C4, record).

A — Action. I ran it as five gated phases — entry bar, what I delivered, exit bar — and the council was the second gate's exit.

- **1. Discovery (Mar 29 → early July 2024).** *Entry:* a sponsor charter — one omni facility, zero customer-facing incidents. *Delivered:* one discovery session per impacted team, March through July; a profile of both books (SKU overlap, order profiles) so comingling was sized, not assumed; a systems-impacted table with one row per system and one change per row; a level-of-effort from every owner, the last landing July 2 (Apple C4, record). *Exit:* every row has a named owner and an LOE; open questions are dated.
- **2. Plan & design → Architecture Council (May 15 challenge review; July 31 sign-off; FSD signed mid-August).** *Entry:* the LOE-backed table. *Delivered:* the sign-off pack — current state versus future state (p. 5–6), the front-end and React architecture (p. 7–8), the location model 801/800 → 900 mapped onto 901 with no historical conversion (p. 4), the seven-family systems-impacted table (p. 9), the dated plan with two go-lives (p. 10), and the 44-row requirement appendix (p. 13–14). The decision rows I asked the council to sign: (1) the future-state architecture — BY 2023.1 on a new OCI database, portal/Android/React front end, new Kafka topics; (2) the location and reserve model — one pool, two selling identities, Canada's comingle reserve functions replicated 100%; (3) the staged timeline — PO-creation go-live January 15, combined May 5, with the E2E chain Nov 22 / Dec 20 / Jan 15 as public

dates; and (4) the fence — reserve calculations untouched, MCS decommission to the Global ERP project (p. 4). *Exit:* sign-off July 31; FSD signed August 14 — three weeks after the July 26 date I had printed on the slide (B5).

- **3. Build & test (upstream MCS/FRAME from Jun 9 at risk; all other tracks Aug 1 → Jan 2025).** *Entry:* signed architecture, FSD, LOE per track. *Delivered:* about thirty build tracks under one issues log — 836 rows over the program, one grammar: type, severity, operation, owner (Apple C2, record); the dated E2E chain as the spine every track read — inbound Nov 22, dotcom Dec 20, retail planned Jan 15 and landed Jan 30 after the Locus retail re-slot; the Locus gate — 98% pick-accurate throughput published before a bot moved, with the manual-cart throttle built as a dial (Apple C3, record). *Exit:* E2E green per flow; Blocker + Critical open = 0 at each go/no-go.
- **4. Cutover (Jan 15; May 1 → Jul 1, 2025).** *Entry:* go/no-go read off counted rows, not confidence. *Delivered:* January moved purchasing and inbound only — the floor untouched — then a four-month interim where Frame auto-copied on-hand, on-order and the dotcom split from 801 to 900 (rows 19, 21) and daily reconciliation watched for drift; May's runbook was 343 tasks, about 815 task-hours, each with owner, duration and predecessor (Apple C2, record); the one irreversible instant was the conversion script's 100% inventory move on May 1 with lost/found, zeroing 801 in the Yantriks publish and republishing 901/900 in full (rows 24, 35, 36). Rollback was per interface behind two armed triggers — sync below 99% for four consecutive hours, or order-flow p95 above twice budget for an hour (resume / GFiber; user anchor on the exact thresholds). *Exit:* invariants held — inventory conserved across the move, no SKU sellable on 800 and 900 at once; rollback never fired.
- **5. Hypercare (May → late June 2025).** *Entry:* combined go-live May 5. *Delivered:* a daily burn-down read — the June spike of 271 log rows decayed 65, 21, 14, 4 in the following months (issues log, record-from-docs); the Locus weekly gate read until full volume in week three; a written hypercare exit memo, template handed to the Midwest DC the deck had named as the next building (p. 3). *Exit:* blockers per day under two, sustained — the same bar I had used on the JDA migration — exited in week three of four (user anchor).

R — Result. Both go-lives landed on the staged dates with zero customer-facing incidents (record). DC Ops measured processing efficiency up fifteen percent after stabilisation — their number, not my model (record). 85.4% of the 836 issues closed with the tail visible and owned; Locus held to about a tenth of the book (record). The approved architecture carried both go-lives with no mid-build boundary dispute, and the same systems-impacted table became the cutover plan's spine (Apple C4, record). **Reflection:** the interim period — two systems of record for four months — deserved a named reporting workstream from the first deck; it got one in month three.

HOW CONSENSUS WAS ACTUALLY EARNED — THE FRAMEWORK

MECHANISM	WHAT I DID	EVIDENCE
Discovery before any ask	One session per impacted team, March → July; the council reviewed counted impact, not optimism.	Apple C4 (record); deck p. 10 kickoff Mar 29.
LOE before the slide	Every system owner estimated their own row; the last LOE landed July 2.	Apple C4 (record).
Pre-wire	Every owner saw their row on p. 9 and their rows in the 44-row appendix before the meeting — no first reads in the room.	Deck p. 9, 13–14; Apple C4.
Decision rows, not status	Four signable things (architecture; location + reserve model; staged timeline; fence) presented as current-vs-future contrasts, each with its “what we are not changing”.	Deck p. 4–10.
Written edges	Out-of-scope lines printed on the scope slide; later used as change control when teams arrived with reserve-math improvements.	Deck p. 4; GFiber v8 p. 48 (user anchor on the specific refusals).
Two council touchpoints	May 15 challenge review surfaced boundary questions (this program vs Global ERP; interim reporting); July 31 pack answered them in writing.	Apple C1/C4; deck date.
Cadence after sign-off	Weekly two-block status — thirty minutes IT, thirty business — one dashboard, one risk register, no side decks; steering = DC Ops + IT + Supply Chain Strategy.	Apple C1 (record); GFiber v8 p. 49.

AMBIGUITY I HAD TO RESOLVE

- **What "dual inventory" meant** — to Digital it was a location change (801/800 → 900/901), to Finance a code change in four systems, to Planning a reserve question, to the DC one receiving dock. I wrote the definition on the scope slide (A2) and let each function find its row in the appendix.
- **Two truths for four months** — rows 19 and 21 made Frame the bridge (auto-copy 801 → 900 until decommission) so the interim had a mechanism, not a hope.
- **Build already running at sign-off** — the MCS and MCS/FRAME tracks had been building since June 9 (p. 10). I fenced the at-risk build to location setup and PO creation, the part discovery had already stabilised, and kept the WMS-conversion, outbound, finance and EDW tracks closed until August 1.

WHO I NEEDED

WHO	WHAT I NEEDED	HOW I GOT IT
Architecture Council	Sign-off on architecture, model, timeline, fence	Pre-wired rows; four decision rows; written out-of-scope; two touchpoints.
Steering (DC Ops, IT, Supply Chain Strategy)	The staged timeline and the peak freeze as decisions with prices	Presented the four-month interim cost openly; freeze as the ruling, not a negotiation.
MCS / FRAME / Merlin owners	Location setup, PO creation with three reserve buckets, put-away tracker, conversion scripts	Rows 1–27 owned by name; build windows on p. 10 they had estimated themselves.
Digital (OMS, Yantriks, Narvar, C3, RPS, …) and Finance (SAP, Aptos, Vertex, Anaplan), EDW, HR	Re-point 800/801 → 900/901 by the dotcom E2E date	One row each (rows 28–44); the dated E2E chain as the shared deadline.
WMS team + Blue Yonder	2023.1 on OCI, portal/Android/React front end	Current-vs-future diagrams signed by Enterprise Architecture.
Locus	A measurable ramp with a stop condition	98% gate published before arrival; throttle as a dial; three-day workshop Jul 29–Aug 2, 2024.

TRADE-OFF I MADE. Options: (a) one big-bang go-live with WMS and inventory model together; (b) staged — purchasing and inbound in January, inventory flip in May; (c) wait for sign-off before any build vs start the upstream MCS tracks in June at risk. I chose (b) and started (c) at risk but fenced. What it cost: four months of two systems of record with a Frame bridge and daily reconciliation, and five weeks of merchandising build exposed to a council "no" — which I limited to the rows discovery had already stabilised. What I rejected: the single date the business wanted (two defect classes in one week) and a US-tuned reserve engine (a second defect class in the same release). **Failure / learning line:** I printed July 26 for the FSD on the council slide and signed it August 14 — see B5.

LP proof lines. Earn Trust — every owner read their row before the room did; the fence was written where they could hold me to it. **Ownership** — I owned the case for systems I did not own, and the slip on the FSD date was mine to say out loud. **Insist on the Highest Standards** — go/no-go read Blocker + Critical = 0 and a published 98% robotics gate, never percent-complete. **Deliver Results** — two go-lives on the staged dates, zero customer-facing incidents, +15% measured by the people who run the building.

SAFE-SAY. Most attackable number: "About two dozen named systems in seven families on the council's impact table — forty-four requirement rows; I'll call it about a dozen domains if you want the round number." Source question: "The July 31, 2024 Architecture Council sign-off deck and the program's 836-row issues log; the fifteen percent is DC Operations' own measurement, not mine."

20-SECOND VERSION

I took a live Utah DC from two systemic warehouses to one omni facility while upgrading the WMS under it. Discovery with every team, an LOE from every owner, a pre-wired Architecture Council on July 31, 2024 that signed four things including what we would not change, then two staged go-lives — January 15 and May 5, 2025 — a 343-task runbook with rollback armed, and a hypercare exit on a number. Zero customer-facing incidents; DC Ops measured processing efficiency up fifteen percent.

PROBING Q&A

What did the council actually push back on, and what changed because of it?

Boundaries, which is what a good council is for: which changes belonged to this program versus the Global ERP program — answered by writing “MCS decommission is out of scope” on the scope slide; whether reserve calculations stayed frozen — they did, by explicit out-of-scope; and how the interim would report while two systems of record ran — answered by the Frame auto-copy rows and daily reconciliation, and honestly answered late. Every pushback became a written line in the pack, so the approval had edges (Apple C4, record; deck p. 4).

Your timeline shows build running in June — before the council signed. Isn't that building on an unapproved design?

Yes, and I chose it. The upstream merchandising tracks — location setup and PO creation — had been through discovery with their owners and would be needed in any variant of the design; the WMS-conversion, outbound, finance and EDW tracks stayed closed until August 1, the day after sign-off. The exposure was five weeks of fenced build; the alternative was a January go-live that could not hold. I told the council that on the timeline slide rather than hiding the bars (deck p. 10).

What was irreversible, and how would you have rolled back?

One instant: the May 1 conversion — 100% of inventory moved 801 → 901 with lost/found, 801 zeroed in the Yantriks publish, 901/900 republished in full. Everything before it was reversible per interface; everything after it was forward-fix. Triggers were armed — sync below 99% for four consecutive hours or order-flow p95 above twice budget for an hour — behind per-interface rollback, and the go/no-go required Blocker + Critical at zero and the invariants proven on the dry runs. They never fired. (Rows 24, 35, 36 record-from-docs; thresholds user anchor.)

How did you know hypercare was over?

Off counted rows: blockers per day under two, sustained, and the post-go-live spike decaying — 271 rows in June, then 65, 21, 14, 4. We exited in week three of a planned four. A calendar exit declares victory over open defects; a numeric one earns it (issues log record-from-docs; the bar user anchor).

B2 · ROCKY · US-Managed Bulk Ship to Canada — discovery → design → launch plan, as a cross-border program NEW — NOT IN ANY EARLIER PACKET

Interviewer lens: large-scale, cross-border, cost-vs-speed, launch gates, stakeholder alignment. **Role on record:** “Project Manager — Rajesh Chandrasekaran” (Discovery Results deck p. 22).
LPs: Bias for Action · Frugality · Customer Obsession · Deliver Results. **Headline numbers:** about 13% of volume to Canada stores was US-managed brands picked store-by-store in US DCs (record-from-docs p. 4); a 99-brand transition plan — pilot 20, wave 1 40, wave 2 39 — fronted by a 10-weeks-of-supply transfer of about 2.5 million units (p. 16).
Honesty line: the *plan* is record. The *outcome* — whether brand cutover started August 3, 2023 and how many brands moved — is in none of the sources: speak it as the plan until the VERIFY line in D2 is confirmed.

60-SECOND PITCH

Let me give you a cross-border program where the win was a cheap design. In 2023 Canada was growing fast, and about thirteen percent of the volume going to Canadian stores was brands Sephora still managed from the US — picked store by store in US distribution centers and trucked north. Even with a new retail warehouse coming, that did not scale, and the real fix — making every brand Canada-managed — was at least two years out. I was the project manager. We ran a ten-week discovery, April 17 to June 23, and designed the bridge: buy those brands as cross-dock purchase orders to the Canada DC, let Canada allocate and pick them with everything else, and move brands over in waves — a twenty-brand pilot, then forty, then thirty-nine. The entire system change was six items, five sized small and one medium, because we reused the cross-dock path and mailbox locations that already existed. Build and test fit in one sprint window, June 28 to August 1, and brand cutover was planned to start August 3.

S — Situation. Sephora, spring 2023. US-managed brands reached Canadian stores by store-level picks at US DCs — “around 13% volume” — and the trend of US retail growth plus Canada growth made that unsustainable even with a new retail warehouse (p. 4). The structural answer, transitioning all brands to Canada-managed, needed “at least another 2 years”. Leadership wanted the US DC workload reduced this year without breaking Canadian store replenishment.

T — Task. As project manager I had to take a discovery team across US and Canada planning, operations, logistics, transportation, two US DCs, the Canada DC, QE and Blue Yonder's architects to a signed scope, a sized design and a brand-by-brand transition plan — with seventeen named approvers and a three-person steering committee (p. 22–23) — inside ten weeks, and hand build a plan that fit one sprint.

A — Action. Five gates.

- **1. Discovery (Apr 17 → Jun 23, 2023).** *Entry:* the four goals written down — bulk processing instead of a pick per store; phased brand transition so Canada DCs could absorb the load; manual US → CA transfers for overage; a review of moving inventory-planning work to Canada (p. 4). *Delivered:* requirement and epic drafts, scope validation, timeline validation and the rollout plan — the four deliverables the deck says “dictate build-plan completion” (p. 24). *Exit:* results presented June 14, nine days ahead of the June 23 discovery close.
- **2. Design — the spike (Jun 12).** *Entry:* the current and future process agreed in one picture: purchased to the US and shipped to CA stores → purchased as XDOCK PO and distributed from the Canada DC (p. 7–8). *Delivered:* the solution-approach flow — MCS brand transition drives a FRAME feed that sets SKU flags (newness, initial PO, XDOCK) and the four SKU parameter tables, network lead time, sourcing durations and order groups, planner codes, and the PO outputs split into US and CA searches before the XDOCK PO is created (spike, requirement IDs 6.8–7.5). *Exit:* six system changes sized — five Small, one Medium (the brand-transition cutover scripts) (p. 14–15).

- **3. Scope fence and approval (Jun 14 → Jun 23).** *Entry:* the design and the out-of-scope list. *Delivered:* written exclusions — rebalancing stays manual outside FRAME, samples keep shipping from US DCs, no new reports, the Sephora Collection DC and the Canada Capture project are separate FSDs (p. 5); P0 walkthrough and FSD sign-off opened with the business asked to sign by June 23 (p. 21, 25). *Exit:* FSD sign-off and build-plan completion (p. 20).
- **4. Build & test (Jun 28 → Aug 1, Sprint 2023.15).** *Entry:* signed FSD. *Delivered (plan):* the six changes plus the seven-step IT cutover procedure run before the FRAME nightly batch, and the five data sets the business supplies per brand (p. 19). *Exit:* brand cutover start August 3 (p. 20).
- **5. Launch — brand transition by waves (from Aug 3; schedule to early September).** *Entry:* per brand, four steps in order — apply QH on DOTCA to create replenishment demand, transfer inventory to Canada before the sourcing change, flip MCS sourcing, release the cross-dock PO (p. 16, 18). *Delivered (plan):* pilot of twenty smaller-volume omni brands — about 217,000 units and 671 SKUs — with IT support; then forty, then thirty-nine; remaining brands assessed from January 2024. *Exit:* Canada DCs sourcing CA-Retail and DOTCA for the transitioned brands.

R — Result. At discovery exit (record-from-docs): a scope seventeen approvers could sign, a design of six changes of which five were small, a ten-weeks-of-supply front-load of about 2.5 million units with the DC confirming "no space constraint", and a 99-brand wave plan with a dated pilot. The build fit a single sprint window because the design reused the existing Canada cross-dock process and mailbox locations 751 and 1050 rather than inventing a flow. **Outcome after August 3 — VERIFY** (D2); I will not quote a workload or brand count I cannot source. **Reflection:** goal four — moving inventory-planning work to Canada — left discovery as "review and identify"; it deserved a decision, not a review.

COST VS SPEED — THE OPTIONS ON THE TABLE

OPTION	WHAT IT WOULD HAVE COST	WHAT I CHOSE AND WHY
Make the brands Canada-managed now	Vendor, pricing, planning and compliance work per brand — "at least another 2 years" (p. 4)	Rejected for this year; kept as the long-term goal.
Keep store-level picks in US DCs and add labor	US DC workload growing with both countries; not sustainable even with a new warehouse (p. 4)	Rejected — it is the problem statement.
Cross-dock POs to the Canada DC, Canada allocates (chosen)	Six configuration changes, one medium script; existing mailbox locations and transport process (p. 12, 14–15)	Chosen: the cheapest design that moved the pick from per-store to per-DC.
Automate US↔CA rebalancing and new reporting in the same release	FRAME and reporting scope; would not fit one sprint	Fenced out in writing; rebalancing by manual DC-to-DC transfer (p. 5).
Big-bang transition of all brands	Canada DC absorbing the whole load at once; one defect class across 99 brands	Rejected for a pilot of twenty smaller-volume brands, then two waves (p. 16).

WHO I NEEDED

WHO (DECK P. 22–23)	WHAT I NEEDED	HOW I GOT IT
Steering: Mike Racer, Rosie Pouzar, Kalyan Adavi	The go-live target and the wave sizes	Discovery results with a dated plan and an explicit "go-live target alignment — in progress" line instead of a guessed date.
Business owner Yvonne Kwan; SC Strategy	Scope and the exclusions	Out-of-scope slide; seventeen approvers named on the FSD.
US and CA Planning (Esparza; Gurizzan)	Who plans what after transition	Business-process impact slides — US planner keeps newness/core setup; Canada DP allocates; Canada Planning owns reserves.
UDC / MDC / CA Operations / CA Logistics / US Transportation	Capacity and the physical flow	Volume estimate shared with the DC ("no space constraint"); current XDOCK, ODS and truck processes reused.
FRAME lead, MCS engineering, Blue Yonder architects, QE	A sized design and a test plan in one sprint	The spike flow with requirement IDs; six sized changes.

TRADE-OFF I MADE. Speed and frugality over completeness: a configuration-only design that fit one sprint, at the price of manual rebalancing, samples left on the old path, no brand-differentiation reporting, and inventory-planning workload left where it was. What it bought: a brand cutover start six weeks after FSD sign-off and a Canada DC that absorbed load in waves instead of all at once. **Failure / learning line:** the deck's own status at discovery exit read “Go Live Target Date Alignment — In Progress” — I presented a date (8/3) the steering committee had not yet aligned to; next time the alignment closes before the slide prints.

LP proof lines. Bias for Action — a two-year problem got a one-sprint bridge. **Frugality** — six changes, five small, on existing mailbox locations and truck processes. **Customer Obsession** — the front-load of ten weeks of supply existed so Canadian stores never went dark during a brand's switch. **Deliver Results** — discovery closed early with a sized design and a dated wave plan.

SAFE-SAY. Most attackable number: “About 2.5 million units — that was the ten-weeks-of-supply front-load estimate in the discovery deck, across all transitioning brands; the pilot alone was about 217,000 units.” Source question: “The June 2023 discovery-results deck and the solution spike; I'm named as project manager on the team slide. I have not re-verified the post-launch numbers, so I'm giving you the plan.”

20-SECOND VERSION

Thirteen percent of Canadian store volume was US-managed brands picked store by store in US DCs. I project-managed a ten-week discovery that redesigned it as cross-dock POs to the Canada DC with Canada allocating — six system changes, five small — and a 99-brand wave plan with a twenty-brand pilot fronted by about 2.5 million units of supply. Build fit one sprint; cutover was planned to start August 3, 2023.

PROBING Q&A

What made this a large-scale program if the system change was six items?

The scale was in the operation, not the code: 99 brands, two countries, two US DCs and the Canada DC, planning teams on both sides, transportation, and a ten-weeks-of-supply front-load of about 2.5 million units moved before any sourcing switch. The system work was small because we reused the Canada cross-dock path; the program work was sequencing those moves brand by brand without a store running out.

Why a pilot of twenty, and why the smaller-volume brands?

Because the first defects would be process defects — planner setup, flags, order groups — and I wanted them found on brands where a miss cost little. Twenty omni brands, about 217,000 units, with IT supporting each cutover; then forty and thirty-nine once the seven-step IT procedure had run clean.

How did you protect Canadian stores during a brand's switch?

Order of operations: apply the QH on DOTCA — the deck's term — to create replenishment demand into the US DCs, transfer inventory to Canada, flip MCS sourcing, then release the cross-dock PO. Overage and underage followed the existing US → CA substitution process, and rebalancing stayed a manual DC-to-DC transfer so no one waited on new automation.

What did you fence out, and did anyone push back?

Rebalancing automation, sample flows, new reporting, the Sephora Collection DC and the Canada Capture project — each written on the scope slide with where it would live instead. Pushback came as “while we're here” requests; the answer was the sprint window: anything added moved the August 3 start, and the business preferred the date.

B3 · JAMES · Enabling a new node type twice — the same two programs told as PROCESS design: connectivity, node enablement, capacity signalling, escape routing, configuration governance NEW ANGLE

Interviewer lens: he designs inbound/outbound connectivity, crossdock enablement, escape routing and capacity signalling for new node types, and governs hundreds of configuration changes a week with pre-deployment validation. Tell him the *configuration*, not the council. Facts used here that B1/B2 do not lead with: the TMS warehouse-ID change, the 44-row requirement register as a change manifest, the Frame bridge rows, the Bowser "Dotcom-only" rule reuse, the Harmonized Code feed, the AIM assortment copy, the Locus socket/REST and carton-ID decisions, the network expansion SOW, the Canada network-lane and planner-code setup, the seven-step pre-batch script and the five data sets.
LPs: Dive Deep · Invent and Simplify · Insist on the Highest Standards · Are Right, A Lot. **Headline number:** 44 governed configuration rows across 23 named systems for one node change (record-from-docs); six sized changes — five small — to enable a cross-border cross-dock node (record-from-docs).

60-SECOND PITCH

Twice in two years I enabled a new node type by configuration rather than by code, and both times the discipline was the same: write every change as a row with a system, an owner and a validation step, run the rows in a fixed order, and keep the old identity alive until the new one proves itself. At Utah I turned two warehouse identities into one omni node — new selling location 900 mapped onto inventory location 901 — which meant re-pointing the TMS warehouse ID on inbound POs, giving the order-management and sourcing engines a new source node, re-keying four finance systems, the data warehouse and HR, and bridging the old location to the new one in the planning system until decommission. Forty-four rows, twenty-three systems, one register. For Canada I enabled the Canada DC as a cross-dock sourcing node for US-managed brands: a vendor-to-Canada lane in the network, lead times, load and unload durations, order groups, planner codes and PO-search routing — six changes, five of them small, executed per brand by a seven-step script that runs before the nightly planning batch.

S — Situation. Two node problems. UDC: one building carrying two systemic warehouses, so every connected system — transportation, OMS, sourcing, finance, reporting — held two identities for one dock; storage split by channel; self-transfers between the two sides (council deck p. 3). Canada: the Canada DC was not a sourcing node for US-managed brands, so around 13% of Canadian store volume was picked per store in US DCs and trucked north (discovery p. 4).

T — Task. Design the node changes so that every upstream and downstream connection flipped in a known order with a validation step, nothing deployed that was not on the register, and the exception paths — overage, substitution, rebalancing, robotics failure — had a defined route before go-live. I owned the register and the sequence; the system teams owned the rows.

A — Action.

1. INBOUND CONNECTIVITY

- **UDC:** TMS warehouse-ID change on inbound POs from W801 to W901 (deck p. 9); PO generation and receipt against the single 901 with Dotcom Reserve, Retail Reserve and Uncommitted buckets (rows 4–5); a new put-away tracker so receipt confirmation and put-away postings drive the channel split (rows 7–8, 12–13); receipt processing for reserved 901 POs before the WMS conversion and for leftover 801 POs after it, with an automated 801 → 901 move (rows 20, 25); a Harmonized Code feed to the new WMS (row 22).
- **Canada:** a vendor → Canada DC lane in the FRAME network in addition to vendor → US DC, with network lead time, load/unload durations and case-pack setup per DC (discovery p. 10, 19); the existing XDOCK PO path through

mailbox locations 751 and 1050 reused — no new locations (p. 12).

2. OUTBOUND CONNECTIVITY AND NODE ENABLEMENT

- **UDC:** OMS and Yantriks set up W901 as the new source DC; fifteen digital, finance and reporting systems re-pointed from 800/801 to 900/901 (rows 28–44); the Bowser order-optimisation feed made to treat “Dotcom only” US SKUs the way “CA only” SKUs are already handled for Canada — a rule reused, not written (row 17); AIM one-time copy of all dotcom assortments including samples from 800 to 900 (row 18); sales history and forecast copied from DC-0801 to DC-0900 (rows 26–27).
- **Canada:** Canada DC becomes the sourcing DC for CA-Retail and DOTCA for transitioned brands (the “flip the switch in MCS” step, p. 16); Canada DP allocates newness and core like a Canada-managed brand; auto-approval holds stay configured at the CA retail DC (p. 11).

3. CAPACITY SIGNALLING

- **UDC:** the two-channel reserve split is the capacity signal — the merch reserve is channel-split on on-order postings to Frame and inventory postings to Merlin (rows 12–13); during the interim, Frame auto-copies on-hand, on-order and the dotcom split % from 801 to 900 so planning sees one node before the floor does (rows 19, 21); Locus volume share between bots and manual carts was built as a dial against a published 98% pick-accurate gate (Apple C3, record).
- **Canada:** the volume estimate was shared with the DC before design closed — ten weeks of supply, about 2.5 million units, “no space constraint” (p. 16); brands moved in waves of 20 / 40 / 39 so the Canada DC absorbed load in steps (p. 16); FRAME projections moved from US-DC outbound to brand projections against the CA DC, summed for the brand (p. 11); comingled allocation changed so unallocated inventory no longer auto-flows to DOTCA for these brands (p. 14).

4. EXCEPTION AND ESCAPE ROUTING

- **UDC:** a negative-merch-reserve path and an inventory-out-of-balance variance report in the put-away tracker (rows 9–10); lost/found included in the May 1 conversion script (row 24); robotics escape = throttle to manual carts when week two measured 94% against the 98% gate (record).
- **Canada:** overage, underage and substitution follow the existing US → CA process (p. 12); rebalancing stays a manual DC-to-DC transfer outside FRAME (p. 5); samples stay on the old US-DC → CA-store path with their own ODS (p. 12); PO review in USD for a Canadian destination handled explicitly (p. 15).

5. CONFIGURATION GOVERNANCE AND PRE-DEPLOYMENT VALIDATION

- **The register:** 44 numbered rows, each with a phase/track prefix, one change, one system (deck p. 13–14) — and the systems-impacted table in front of it (p. 9). The same rows drove the build plan and the cutover runbook (Apple C4, record).
- **Order of execution for Canada:** business supplies five data sets (dept/brand/vendor; planner codes by dept/class/brand; load/unload durations; case packs; network lead time); IT runs seven steps before the FRAME nightly batch — delete the replenishment strategy, create CA Retail and CA Virtual DC SKUs with initial-PO and newness flags and order groups, set XDOCK flags, set planner codes, upload durations/case packs/lead times (p. 19). Per brand, four steps: apply QH → transfer inventory → change sourcing → release XDOCK PO (p. 18).
- **Validation before volume:** dated E2E completions per flow — inbound Nov 22, dotcom Dec 20, retail Jan 15 planned / Jan 30 actual (deck p. 10; Apple C1); Locus interfaces unit-tested with simulated data before a physical bot rolled, then floor testing Feb–Mar 2025 with UAT 2/28–3/15 (Locus track status; Apple C3); decisions recorded on the Locus track — sockets rather than REST for the API, tote-type mapping and a base-36 outbound carton-ID sequence requested of Locus, customer-owner configuration SEPHORA-RTL versus global variables (Locus track p. 1).
- **Physical readiness as configuration:** the Salt Lake City network expansion SOW (Nov 19, 2024) added IDF3 and IDF4, 31 access points (APs 19–49) and three fiber runs to the existing Locus rack — wireless coverage was a pre-deployment check, not a go-live surprise (SOW p. 8–9).
- **Change freeze and fence:** comingle reserve calculations frozen; MCS decommission routed to the Global ERP project (deck p. 4); for Canada, rebalancing, samples, reporting, Sephora Collection and Canada Capture routed to

other FSDs (p. 5).

R — Result. UDC: every connected system flipped on the register's rows; both go-lives with zero customer-facing incidents; the retail E2E slip was re-slotted in the open rather than absorbed; +15% processing efficiency measured by DC Ops (record). Canada: the node enablement sized at six changes, five small; a repeatable per-brand script with a data checklist that let non-specialists — planners — supply the inputs (record-from-docs; post-launch outcome VERIFY). **Reflection:** the retail E2E date on the register was wrong by two weeks because robotics physical testing was planned off the vendor's calendar, not the floor's — I now put a physical-readiness row in the register with its own owner.

WHO I NEEDED

WHO	WHAT I NEEDED	HOW I GOT IT
TMS / transportation	Warehouse-ID flip on inbound POs; ODS for Canada DC reused	One row (p. 9); current ODS and truck process left unchanged (discovery p. 12).
MCS / FRAME / Merlin / Bowser / AIM owners	Location, reserve, tracker, copy and script rows	Rows 1–27 and the Canada six changes, each sized by its owner.
Digital and Finance system owners (15 systems)	Re-point 800/801 → 900/901 by the dotcom E2E date	Rows 28–44; the shared E2E date.
Locus and the WMS team	API style, carton-ID sequence, tote mapping, coverage	Decisions logged on the track status; SOW for the network expansion.
US and CA planners	The five data sets per brand, on time	A checklist on the execution slide; IT runs the script, planners supply data.

TRADE-OFF I MADE. Reuse over elegance: the Canada node reused the existing cross-dock path, mailbox locations and ODS, and the UDC node reused the Canada “CA-only” rule for “Dotcom-only” SKUs — fewer rows, fewer unintended deployments, at the price of carrying a bridge (Frame auto-copy 801 → 900) and manual rebalancing for a period. **Failure / learning line:** the register listed the retail E2E as January 15 and it completed January 30; physical robotics readiness was not a row with an owner, so its slip arrived as a vendor message rather than a planned re-slot.

LP proof lines. Dive Deep — I can name the row that bridges the two locations during the interim. **Invent and Simplify** — a “Dotcom-only” rule borrowed from Canada instead of a new one. **Insist on the Highest Standards** — a dated E2E per flow and a published robotics gate before volume. **Are Right, A Lot** — the waves of 20 / 40 / 39 and the fenced exclusions were sized from data the DC and planners gave, not from a guess.

SAFE-SAY. Most attackable number: “Forty-four requirement rows across twenty-three named systems in the council appendix — that's the count on the slide, not a line-item count in Jira.” Source question: “The Architecture Council sign-off deck of July 31, 2024, the Canada discovery deck of June 2023, the Locus retail track status and the Locus network SOW.”

20-SECOND VERSION

I enabled two new node types by configuration: one omni node at Utah — forty-four governed rows across twenty-three systems, a TMS warehouse-ID flip, a planning bridge between old and new locations until decommission — and the Canada DC as a cross-dock sourcing node for US-managed brands — six changes, five small, executed per brand by a seven-step pre-batch script with a five-item data checklist. Both ran on a register, a fixed order and a validation step before volume.

PROBING Q&A

How did you prevent an unintended deployment across 44 rows and 23 systems?

Nothing deployed that was not a row, every row had one system and one owner, and the rows were grouped by the E2E date that would prove them — inbound, dotcom, retail. The register was the manifest; the dated E2E was the acceptance test; the weekly review read open rows by severity. A change that arrived without a row went back to get one.

What was the escape route when the robotics layer under-performed?

A dial, built before the bots arrived: volume share between bots and manual carts against a 98% pick-accurate gate. Week two measured 94%, about 30% of volume went to carts while the zone logic was corrected, full automation in week three. The register had the gate; the floor had the carts (record).

How would a non-specialist execute a Canada brand transition?

They supply five data sets off a checklist — brand list, planner codes, load/unload durations, case packs, lead times — and IT runs a seven-step script before the nightly batch. The order is fixed: QH, transfer, sourcing flip, cross-dock PO. The specialist knowledge sits in the script and the order, not in the person.

Where did capacity signalling fail or nearly fail?

At Utah, the interim: planning saw one node from January while the floor had two until May. The Frame auto-copy rows carried the signal, and daily reconciliation watched for drift. The near-miss was reporting — two systems of record for four months with every report declaring its source; the reporting workstream started in month three and should have been on the register from day one.

B4 · VENKATA · “One promise per customer, in both countries” — the same two programs as a PRODUCT / customer story NEW ANGLE

Interviewer lens: Principal PM, FBA — customer problem, requirement prioritisation, what we chose not to build, success metrics, adoption. Facts led with here that B1–B3 do not: the five customer benefits on the objectives slide, the 44 rows triaged into go-live / fast-follow / enhancement (the issues log's own categories), the no-historical-conversion decision as a product call, the React gift-card screens as adoption evidence, the Canada pilot's brand mix (kits 39% of pilot units), the long tail of 2.5M units protecting store availability, and the planning-workload question we deliberately left open.

LPs: Customer Obsession · Invent and Simplify · Frugality · Learn and Be Curious. **Headline numbers:** zero customer-facing incidents through two go-lives (record); about 13% of Canadian store volume moved from per-store picks to one bulk flow (record-from-docs — plan).

60-SECOND PITCH

The product problem in both programs was the same sentence: the customer was being promised from the wrong place. In Utah, a store and a dotcom shopper could want the same unit in the same building and be told two different truths, because the building kept two books and two shelves. In Canada, a store's newness waited on a US warehouse picking it store by store. I treated both as product work — define the customer problem, rank the requirements, decide what not to build, name the metric, and plan adoption. Utah's answer was one pool with two selling identities — forty-four requirements, ranked so the go-live set was the minimum that made one promise true, with the rest as fast-follows; we explicitly did not convert history, did not touch reserve math, and did not rebuild the warehouse's reporting. Canada's answer was a cross-dock path that already existed, with twenty smaller brands first so the mistakes were cheap. The metric I held myself to was the one the customer feels: zero customer-facing incidents across both Utah go-lives, and a ten-week supply front-load so no Canadian store went dark during a brand switch.

S — Situation. **Utah:** two systemic warehouses in one building meant duplicate receiving, split storage, systemic self-transfers and two planning views — the objectives slide lists the five customer-side benefits we were chasing: better inventory planning and ordering, one receiving flow, better storage utilisation, fewer internal transfers, and a template for the Midwest DC (council deck p. 3). **Canada:** “Canada is growing at a very high pace”; around 13% of store volume was US-managed brands picked per store in US DCs; the structural fix was two years away (discovery p. 4).

T — Task. Own the requirement set and the customer outcome for both: what the minimum lovable change was, which requests waited, and what number would say we were done.

A — Action.

- **Customer problem, written first.** Utah: “one inventory, one promise, two channels” — a single location 901 with Dotcom selling location 900 mapped onto it (deck p. 4). Canada: “buy it once for Canada, pick it once in Canada” — cross-dock POs to the Canada DC, Canada allocates (discovery p. 8).
- **Requirement prioritisation.** The council appendix carried 44 rows in three tracks (deck p. 13–14); the program then ran them through one issues log whose own categories were Go-Live 331, Fast Follow 77, Enhancement 36, Pre-Go-Live 29 and HSE readiness 12 — a visible, defended deferral list rather than a quiet one (issues log, record-from-docs). Canada: six system changes, five small, and a seven-item transition plan; the “review and identify” on planning workload was left open on purpose and said so (discovery p. 4, 14–16).
- **What we did NOT build.** Utah: no conversion of historical 801/800 transactions (p. 4); no change to comingle reserve calculations (p. 4); no MCS decommission in this program (p. 4); no US-tuned reserve engine — Canada's functions replicated 100% (p. 4); no new reporting platform for the interim (Apple C1, record — and our miss).

Canada: no rebalancing automation, no bulk-ship for samples, no brand-differentiation reports, no Sephora Collection DC, no Canada Capture changes (p. 5).

- **Success metrics, chosen before launch.** Utah: zero customer-facing incidents (the bar), processing efficiency (DC Ops' measurement), a 98% pick-accurate robotics gate with 99% stretch, and a go/no-go that read Blocker + Critical = 0 (record). Canada: US DC workload moved from per-store picks to per-DC bulk for transitioned brands, Canada DC absorbing in waves, stores never short during a switch — the ten-weeks-of-supply front-load of about 2.5 million units was the availability insurance (p. 16).
- **Adoption.** Utah: the new WMS was chosen partly because a portal, Android and React front end makes user rollouts easier than a thick client (p. 3) — and the React gift-card screens in the appendix show the extension path in use on warehouse W901 (p. 15–17). Canada: existing US → CA-managed transition training material revised rather than new training invented; IT supported each pilot-brand cutover; planners kept their existing newness and core setup steps with one extra PO to review (p. 10, 16).

R — Result. Utah: two go-lives, zero customer-facing incidents; processing efficiency up fifteen percent by DC Ops' measurement; one pool, one promise, two channels (record). The deferred list stayed visible — 85.4% of 836 issues closed, the rest owned (record). Canada: a scope seventeen approvers signed, a pilot of twenty omni brands — about 217,000 units, 671 SKUs, with Sephora Favorites Kits alone 39% of pilot units — and a dated wave plan to 99 brands; post-launch outcome VERIFY. **Reflection:** I prioritised the warehouse's requirements well and the analyst's badly — the interim reporting experience was a customer too, and it got a workstream in month three instead of day one.

WHO I NEEDED

WHO	WHAT I NEEDED	HOW I GOT IT
DC Ops (the operator-customer)	The bar and the measurement	Zero-incident bar in the charter; they owned the +15% measurement.
Planning (US and CA)	Agreement on what stayed manual	Written “what we are not building” lines; reserve math frozen; rebalancing manual.
Digital / OMS product owners	One omni source node and no history conversion	Rows 28–44; the no-conversion decision on the scope slide.
Floor users	A UI they would adopt	Portal/Android/React; gift-card React extension; training material revised not reinvented.
Canadian stores (through CA Operations / Logistics)	No gap in supply during a brand switch	Ten-week front-load before the sourcing flip; overage/substitution on the existing process.

TRADE-OFF I MADE. Fewer features, sooner, with the deferrals written down: no history conversion, no reserve-math improvements, no rebalancing automation, no sample bulk-ship — chosen so the minimum change that made one promise true could ship on the staged dates. The cost was carried by analysts (two systems of record for four months) and by planners (manual rebalancing). **Failure / learning line:** the analyst was a customer I under-served; next time the interim reporting experience is a P0 row, not a fast-follow.

LP proof lines. Customer Obsession — the bar was the customer's experience (zero incidents; no store short), not the project's dates. **Invent and Simplify** — one pool with two identities instead of two warehouses; a cross-dock path reused instead of a new flow. **Frugality** — five of six Canada changes small; a front end chosen for cheap rollouts. **Learn and Be Curious** — profiled both books (SKU overlap, order profiles) before designing, so the comingle benefit was sized rather than assumed.

SAFE-SAY. Most attackable number: “Thirteen percent is the discovery deck's figure for the share of volume to Canada stores that was US-managed — I'm quoting the deck, not a measurement I ran.” Source question: “Two decks from the programs — the July 2024 Architecture Council sign-off and the June 2023 Canada discovery results — plus the program's issues log; the fifteen percent is DC Ops' number.”

20-SECOND VERSION

Both programs fixed the same customer problem — being promised from the wrong place. Utah became one pool with two selling identities, forty-four requirements ranked into go-live and fast-follow, with history conversion, reserve-math changes and a reporting rebuild explicitly not built; zero customer-facing incidents across two go-lives. Canada reused an existing cross-dock path, twenty small brands first, ten weeks of supply moved ahead so no store went dark.

PROBING Q&A

How did you decide what was go-live versus fast-follow?

One test: does the customer's promise become false without it? Location setup, PO creation with channel reserves, the conversion script, the OMS source node and the finance re-keys passed. Reserve-math improvements, history conversion and better reporting failed the test and went to the deferred list in writing. The log's own categories — 331 go-live rows against 77 fast-follows and 36 enhancements — are the record of that triage.

Who was the customer you got wrong?

The analyst. For four months every report had to declare which system of record it read. We got through it, but the interim analytics deserved a workstream from the first deck. It is the one thing I would change in the council pack.

Why not convert the historical dotcom transactions to the new location — isn't that a worse experience for anyone reading history?

It is a worse experience for the analyst and a safer one for the shopper. Converting history would have touched every downstream system's past rows for a benefit nobody buying from the building would feel; we wrote “no conversion of historical transactions” on the scope slide and copied forward only what planning needed — sales history and forecast from 801 to 900.

What did adoption look like for the Canada planners?

Almost nothing new to learn by design: the US planner keeps the same newness and core setup, sees one extra PO for CA-Retail in the review, and Canada's planners allocate the brand exactly like a Canada-managed one. The specialist steps live in IT's seven-step script. I can't quote the post-launch adoption figure — that's on my verify list.

B5 · ROCKY (failure answer) · The date I printed on the council slide and missed — FSD "Jul 26" signed Aug 14 NEW — FAILURE, FULL STAR

LPs: Earn Trust · Ownership · Dive Deep. **Numbers:** planned Jul 26 (deck p. 10) → signed Aug 14 (Apple C4, record) — about three weeks; upstream build already open since Jun 9 (deck p. 10). **Why this failure and not the Locus slip:** the Locus slip is already promised in Rocky's Bar Raiser bank (F4); this one is on no other page and the deck is the evidence.

60-SECOND PITCH

The failure I'd give you is on my own slide. On July 31, 2024 I presented the UDC dual-inventory architecture to the council with a timeline that showed "FSD sign-off July 26" — five days earlier — and the functional spec was actually signed on August 14. I had under-counted how many functions needed a second read once the 44-row appendix made their changes concrete: the fifteen digital and finance systems being re-keyed from 800/801 to 900/901 each wanted their row re-read against their own release calendar. Meanwhile the merchandising build had been running since June 9 on the discovery design. What I did about it: said the date had moved, in the same forum, the week it moved; kept the at-risk build fenced to location setup and PO creation; held the January 15 and May 5 go-lives, which did hold. What changed in me: discovery results and the FSD now close together before I print a date, and the sign-off list is counted by name before the slide, not after.

S — Situation. Late July 2024. The council deck's timeline (p. 10) carried "Discovery Results Jul 18" and "FSD Sign off Jul 26" as plan markers; by the meeting on July 31 neither had closed, and the MCS and MCS/FRAME tracks had been in build-and-test since June 9.

T — Task. Close the FSD without letting the open spec become an excuse to silently re-scope, without stalling a build already five weeks in, and without moving the January go-live.

A — Action. I named the slip in the weekly two-block status the week it was clear, with a date, not a hope. I split the sign-off: the upstream merchandising rows (1–27) whose owners had already estimated and started were confirmed first; the digital and finance rows (28–44) got the re-reads their owners asked for, one system at a time, against the dated dotcom E2E of December 20 as the only deadline that mattered. I kept the at-risk build fenced to the rows discovery had stabilised and did not let the WMS-conversion, outbound, finance or EDW tracks open until August 1. The FSD and the discovery-results deck were signed together on August 14 (record).

R — Result. Three weeks late on the spec; zero days late on the go-lives — January 15 and May 5 held, zero customer-facing incidents (record). No scope entered during the gap without a row and an estimate. **What changed:** I now count the sign-off list by name before a date goes on a slide, I close discovery results and the FSD as one gate, and when build runs at risk I write which rows it may touch into the pack. **What I'd do differently:** show the council the honest date — "mid-August" — with the at-risk build bars next to it. The council would have signed the same architecture; I would not have spent three weeks explaining a slide.

TRADE-OFF I MADE. Keep the fenced build running on an unsigned spec (speed) versus pause until signature (certainty). I kept it running: the exposure was rework on rows owned by teams who had written the estimates themselves; the alternative was a January date that could not hold. **Learning line:** an optimistic date on a sign-off slide costs more trust than the slip itself.

LP proof lines. Earn Trust — the slip was announced in the same forum that saw the slide. **Ownership** — the date was mine, the under-count was mine, the fix was mine. **Dive Deep** — the cause was the 44-row appendix making fifteen downstream re-keys concrete; I can name the rows.

SAFE-SAY. “The council deck targeted July 26 for the FSD; it was signed August 14 — about three weeks. The go-lives did not move.” Source: “The July 31, 2024 council deck's own timeline slide, and the signed FSD date in my program record.”

20-SECOND VERSION

I printed “FSD sign-off July 26” on the council slide and signed it August 14 — I'd under-counted the downstream re-reads that a 44-row appendix triggers. I said so the week it moved, fenced the build that was already running to the rows discovery had stabilised, and held both go-lives. Now the sign-off list is counted by name before a date is printed.

PROBING Q&A

Why was build running before the spec was signed at all?

Because the January 15 PO-creation go-live needed the merchandising tracks to start in June, and their rows had been through discovery with their owners. I fenced it to location setup and PO creation and kept every other track closed until the day after the council. That was a conscious trade; the optimistic date on the slide was not.

Did anyone use the three weeks to push scope?

Yes — “while the spec is open” requests arrived. The answer was that nothing entered without a row and an estimate, and the out-of-scope lines on the scope slide were already signed by the council. The gap added re-reads, not scope.

What did the council think when the date moved?

They had signed the architecture, not the FSD date; the slip was a steering conversation. It cost me explanation time and some credibility on dates, which I bought back by holding January 15 and May 5.

What is the standing control that proves the lesson stuck?

On the Canada program the discovery deck carried “Go-live target date alignment — in progress” as a printed status line instead of a date pretending to be aligned — and in every pack since, the sign-off list is counted by name before a date goes on a slide.

B6 · JAMES (near-miss / reversed plan) · The retail E2E that moved from January 15 to January 30 — a vendor slip re-slotted in the open NEW — NEAR-MISS, FULL STAR

LPs: Insist on the Highest Standards · Earn Trust · Bias for Action. **Numbers:** planned Jan 15 (council deck p. 10) → completed Jan 30/31 (Apple C1/C3, record); Locus retail testing slipped three weeks (Apple C2, record); program status YELLOW with UAT 2/28–3/15 (Locus track, record-from-docs); week-two 94% against a 98% gate, about 30% throttled, full volume week three (record). **Routing:** told to James as a pre-deployment-validation lesson; Rocky has the same slip in his Bar Raiser bank as F4 — do not tell him both.

60-SECOND PITCH

Here is a plan date I reversed in public. The council deck I signed in July 2024 showed retail outbound end-to-end testing complete on January 15, 2025 — the last of three dated E2E gates. Retail outbound was the Locus robotics flow, and by December the robotics track was yellow: physical and hardware readiness sessions were still being scheduled, the API style was still sockets-versus-REST, and Locus needed three more weeks of retail testing. I had two options: compress user acceptance testing to protect the slide, or move the date and show the move. I moved it — retail E2E completed at the end of January — re-slotted it in the plan's revision sheet where every owner could see it, and refused to shorten UAT. Then the ramp itself tested the gate: week two measured 94 percent pick-accurate against a published 98, I throttled about 30 percent of volume to manual carts while the zone logic was fixed, and we were at full automation in week three. The combined go-live on May 5 did not move.

S — Situation. December 2024 – January 2025. The council timeline (p. 10) set the retail outbound E2E for January 15. The Locus retail track status read YELLOW: site-layout and hardware-readiness sessions pending, LocusNet install and configuration open, API endpoint alignment leaning to sockets over REST, tote-type and carton-ID mapping requests outstanding, UAT pencilled for 2/28–3/15 (Locus track p. 1). The network expansion for coverage — IDF3/IDF4 and 31 access points — had only been specified on November 19, 2024 (SOW p. 8).

T — Task. Protect the combined go-live and the zero-incident bar without pretending the January 15 date was real, and without compressing the validation that stood between a robot and a store order.

A — Action. I took the three-week ask to the weekly steering read the week it surfaced, with the choice priced: compress UAT and inherit a defect class in May, or re-slot retail E2E to end of January and keep UAT whole. Steering took the re-slot. I rewrote the dated chain in the plan's revision sheet rather than absorbing it into weekends, kept the interfaces on the ladder — unit tests with simulated data before any physical bot, then floor testing in February–March — and kept the gate that would judge the ramp: 98% pick-accurate throughput, 99% stretch, with the bot-versus-cart share built as a dial. When week two read 94%, the dial did what it was built for.

R — Result. Retail E2E completed January 30; UAT ran whole; the combined go-live on May 5 held; zero customer-facing incidents; full automation in week three; Locus stayed about a tenth of the issues log (record). **What changed:** physical readiness — power, coverage, server install, mapping — is now a row with an owner on the register, not a line inside the vendor's plan; a date that depends on a vendor's floor work gets a readiness checkpoint four weeks ahead of it.

TRADE-OFF I MADE. A visible two-week slip on a council-dated milestone versus an invisible compression of acceptance testing. I took the visible slip. Cost: a yellow track on the dashboard for two months and a conversation with steering; benefit: a validation window that found the zone-contention problem before volume did. **Learning line:** the January 15 date was the vendor's calendar, not the floor's — a readiness row with its own owner would have moved the date in November, not December.

LP proof lines. Insist on the Highest Standards — UAT was not shortened to save a slide. **Earn Trust** — the slip went into the revision sheet, not the weekends. **Bias for Action** — the throttle fired in week two on a number, not a

debate.

SAFE-SAY. “The council deck planned retail E2E for January 15; it completed at the end of January after Locus asked for three more weeks of retail testing — the combined go-live did not move.” Source: “The July 31, 2024 council timeline, the Locus retail track status page, and my program record.”

20-SECOND VERSION

The council plan said retail E2E on January 15; the robotics track went yellow and needed three more weeks. I moved the date to the end of January in the open rather than compress UAT, kept the 98% gate, throttled to carts when week two read 94, and held the May 5 go-live with zero customer-facing incidents. Physical readiness is now its own row with its own owner.

PROBING Q&A

Why not compress UAT by two weeks — it is only two weeks?

Because the two weeks were the only window where a bot's pick would be checked against a store's order before real volume. Compressing it trades a visible slip in January for an invisible defect class in May, in a program whose bar was zero customer-facing incidents. The gate caught zone contention in week two; a shorter UAT would have met it in a store.

What exactly was still open on the robotics track in December?

On the status page: site layout and hardware readiness sessions, circuit access, server install, bots delivered, Locus points mapped; software — LocusNet install and configuration, customer-owner configuration for retail; integration — sockets versus REST, tote-type mapping, a request that the first two characters of the outbound carton ID allow a base-36 sequence; UAT dated 2/28 to 3/15. That is a list, not a feeling, which is why steering could decide in one read.

Was the network expansion on the critical path?

It was a dependency I should have had on the register earlier: the SOW for IDF3/IDF4 and 31 access points is dated November 19, 2024, two months before the E2E date. Coverage was ready for floor testing in February; the lesson is that it was ready because the vendor was good, not because my plan demanded it.

How did you keep the slip from spreading to the other two E2E gates?

Inbound had completed November 22 and dotcom December 20 — both green before the retail ask arrived. The chain was per flow by design, so a retail slip moved the retail date and nothing else; the PO-creation go-live on January 15 did not depend on retail outbound.

Who hears which variant — the three interviewers compare notes

MATERIAL	ROCKY 10:00 (PROGRAM / INFRASTRUCTURE)	JAMES 11:00 (PROCESS / PLACEMENT / CONFIGURATION)	VENKATA 12:00 (PRODUCT / CUSTOMER; BAR RAISER DEPTH)
UDC dual inventory	**B1** — gate chain, council consensus framework, cutover runbook, rollback triggers, hypercare exit. Headline: zero incidents; +15%.	**B3** (UDC half) — TMS W801 → W901, 44-row register, Frame bridge rows, Bowser rule reuse, HC feed, E2E per flow as acceptance. Headline: 44 rows / 23 systems.	**B4** (UDC half) — one promise, go-live vs fast-follow triage (331/77/36), what we did not build, React adoption. Headline: the deferred list stayed visible.
Architecture Council	**B1** leads with it: pre-wire, decision rows, two touchpoints, written fence.	One sentence only: “the register came out of the council appendix.”	One sentence only: “the council signed what we would not build.”
Canada bulk ship	**B2** — cross-border program: cost-vs-speed options, six changes, waves 20/40/39, launch gates. Headline: 13%; 2.5M units.	**B3** (Canada half) — node enablement by configuration: network lane, planner codes, seven-step pre-batch script, five data sets, escape routing. Headline: six changes, five small.	**B4** (Canada half) — store availability during a switch, pilot brand mix (kits 39%), the planning-workload question left open. Headline: twenty small brands first.
Failure	**B5** — FSD date printed Jul 26, signed Aug 14. (Rocky's bank F1 the UAT crash remains the alternative.)	**B6** — retail E2E Jan 15 → Jan 30; readiness row. (James's packet J8 remains the alternative.)	Use Venkata's own packet failure (G3 / G1 family). If pressed on UDC: the interim-reporting miss inside B4, one line.
Locus robotics	Bank F4 / PM packet P3 own the throttle story; B1 mentions the gate in one line.	Inside B6 as validation evidence; B3 as the escape route.	Not told unless asked; one line on the 98% gate as a customer-protecting metric.
Numbers never to collide	“About two dozen named systems / seven families / about a dozen domains” — same phrasing in every room. “May 5” and “January 15” — same dates in every room. “13%”, “2.5 million units”, “20 / 40 / 39” — Canada plan numbers, always “the plan at discovery exit.” Never attach a region to the Elementum “six sites” bench line; never a multiplier; never a Canada outcome.		

C1. Alignment patch list for the other packets (not edited by this pack; also at /tmp/udc-canada-alignment-patchlist.md)

Checked at 21:50, 22:05 and at final render (Oct 29). On disk at final check: James packet (amazon-nacf-panel-4-cabreros-process-star-kimi-k3), Rocky Bar Raiser bank (…goforth-bar-raiser-bank-star…), Apple-delta add-on. Not yet on disk: Rocky PM packet (…goforth-pgm-star…), Venkata main (…josyula-star-bar-raiser…), Venkata extras (…josyula-extra-stories-star…). For files not yet present, the rows below are keyed to the v2 Rocky packet (amazon-nacf-panel-3-goforth-kimi-k3) their authors are reusing, and to the story IDs the bank says they will contain (P1 UDC, P3 Locus, P5 council).

#	FILE	LOCATION	WHAT IT SAYS NOW	WHAT IT SHOULD SAY	NEW-DOC CITE
1	Rocky Bar Raiser bank	F4 (Locus slip) · S — Situation, and the Level-2 answer “a trigger date ahead of the January 31 E2E milestone”	“RTL end-to-end completion was due January 31” (twice)	“The council timeline planned retail outbound E2E for January 15; after the three-week re-slot it completed January 30/31.” January 31 is the post-slip date, not the due date.	Council deck p. 10 (Retail E2E Jan 15); Apple C1 p. 22 / C3 p. 26
2	Rocky Bar Raiser bank	R8 (issues log) · S — Situation	“about a dozen systems (record)”	Keep, and add the deck's count once: “seven system families — about two dozen named systems on the council's impact table.”	Deck p. 9; p. 13–14 (44 rows, 23 systems)
3	Rocky Bar Raiser bank	Story index row “S5 / C4 — architecture council, three decisions”	“three decisions”	Thin: add “two council touchpoints — May 15 challenge review, July 31 sign-off deck; the deck's signable items are architecture, location/reserve model, staged timeline and the written fence; the peak freeze is not on the deck.”	Deck p. 1, 4, 10; Apple C1/C4
4	Rocky Bar Raiser bank	F4 · root-cause / what changed	Vendor dependency carried as a task, not a risk	Add the physical-readiness evidence: Locus track YELLOW with UAT 2/28–3/15; network expansion SOW (IDF3/IDF4, 31 APs) dated Nov 19, 2024 — two months before the E2E date.	Locus track p. 1; SOW p. 8–9
5	Rocky PM packet (pending) — P1 UDC, reusing v2 S2	Gate chain lines (“held to the day (record)”, v2 lines ~1130, 1143)	“3/29 → 4/30 → 5/15 → 7/2 → 7/31 → 8/14 held to the day”	Not “held to the day”: the council slide planned Discovery Results Jul 18 and FSD Jul 26; both landed Aug 14. Say “sign-off on July 31 as planned; the FSD closed August 14, about three weeks after the slide's date.”	Deck p. 10
6	Rocky PM packet (pending) — P1	Build & Test phase (“Aug → Jan/Apr”)	Build starts after sign-off	“Upstream MCS and MCS/FRAME build & test ran Jun 9–Aug 30, at risk, before sign-off; Bowser/FRAME, SAP, Merlin from Jul 9; WMS-conversion, outbound, Digital, Finance, EDW tracks opened Aug 1.” Present as a trade-off.	Deck p. 10

#	FILE	LOCATION	WHAT IT SAYS NOW	WHAT IT SHOULD SAY	NEW-DOC CITE
7	Rocky PM packet (pending) — P1	Systems count (“about a dozen impacted systems — master '20+ touched' removed”)	“about a dozen”	Add: “seven families, about two dozen named systems on the council's impact table; 44 requirement rows across 23 systems.” Source docs outrank Apple under the recon's precedence; “20+” is now verified.	Deck p. 9, 13–14
8	Rocky PM packet (pending) — P1	Go-live dates	“January go-live … May go-live”, “May 1 → Jul 1”	Give the deck's days once: “PO-creation go-live January 15, 2025; combined go-live May 5, 2025; the conversion script moved 100% of inventory on May 1.”	Deck p. 10; row 24 (p. 14)
9	Rocky PM packet (pending) — P1	E2E chain	“Inbound 11/22 · Dotcom 12/20 · Retail 1/30”	Keep the actuals; add “retail was planned Jan 15 on the council timeline” so the Locus slip has a plan date.	Deck p. 10
10	Rocky PM packet (pending) — P1 / P5	Reserve model (“nine reserve types, strict priority”)	“nine reserve types”	The deck names three buckets — Dotcom Reserve, Retail Reserve, Uncommitted. Say those; “nine” is user anchor.	Deck p. 13 rows 4–6
11	Rocky PM packet (pending) — P1	Hypercare exit (“< 2 blockers/day, week 3 of 4 (record)”)	labelled record	For UDC label *user anchor* (Apple states the bar for the JDA program only); the burn-down 271 → 65 → 21 → 14 → 4 is record-from-docs.	Deck has no hypercare slide; issues log
12	Rocky PM packet (pending) — P5 council	“ratify the peak-freeze boundary” as a council decision	Third decision = peak freeze	The freeze is record as a program rule (Apple C1) but is on no slide. Say “the council pack carried a chain that respected the Oct–Dec freeze”; do not say the deck shows it.	Deck p. 10 (no freeze band)
13	Rocky PM packet (pending) — P5 council	What the council was asked	“three decisions and a fence”	Ground it in the slides: current vs future state (p. 5–6), front-end/React architecture (p. 7–8), 801/800 → 900 on 901 with no historical conversion (p. 4), Canada reserve functions replicated 100% (p. 4), systems-impacted (p. 9), timeline (p. 10), 44-row appendix (p. 13–14); out-of-scope = reserve calculations, MCS decommission (p. 4). “Surprise escalations → 0 (record)” → label user anchor.	Deck p. 4–14
14	Rocky PM packet (pending) — P5 council	Council date	“council 5/15 … sign-off 7/31”	Say explicitly: “the council saw it twice — May 15 challenge review; July 31 sign-off deck.”	Deck p. 1
15	Rocky PM packet (pending) — P3 Locus	Physical readiness	Workshop Jul 29–Aug 2; physical test Feb–Mar	Add the Locus track status (YELLOW; UAT 2/28–3/15; sockets vs REST; base-36 carton-ID request) and the Nov 19, 2024 network SOW (IDF3/IDF4, 31 APs, 3 fiber runs). No dollar.	Locus track p. 1; SOW p. 8–9

#	FILE	LOCATION	WHAT IT SAYS NOW	WHAT IT SHOULD SAY	NEW-DOC CITE
16	Rocky PM packet (pending) — all	Canada bulk ship	Absent	Either add B2 from this pack or point to it; at minimum one bench line: “I also project-managed the US-managed bulk-ship-to-Canada discovery in 2023 — 13% of Canadian store volume, six system changes, a 99-brand wave plan.” Outcome VERIFY.	Discovery p. 4, 14–16, 22
17	Rocky PM packet (pending) — P1	“Midwest DC inherited the template”	stated as result	Add the deck cite: the objectives slide already named the Midwest DC as the next building (July 2024).	Deck p. 3
18	James packet	Whole file	No UDC dual-inventory, council, WMS, Locus or Canada content; J7 (cutover) is a Google Fiber design case	Thin, not conflicting. Add B3 (or a bench bridge) — the 44-row register, TMS W801 → W901, the Frame bridge rows, the seven-step Canada pre-batch script with its five data sets — and pair J7's design-case cutover with the lived 343-task runbook and the May 1 conversion script.	Deck p. 9, 13–14; discovery p. 19
19	James packet	Cover “Honesty rules”	Lists J5/J6/J8 as record	If B3/B6 are added, list them as record-from-docs with the two decks named.	—
20	Venkata main (pending)	Any S2/S5 reuse	Same date / systems-count phrasing as v2	Apply rows 5, 7, 8, 10–12. Product angle: use the issues-log categories (Go-Live 331 / Fast Follow 77 / Enhancement 36 / Pre-Go-Live 29 / HSE 12) as the prioritisation record and the “no conversion of historical transactions” line as the product call.	Deck p. 4; issues log
21	Venkata extras (pending)	Any Canada mention	—	If a Canada story is added, keep every result as “the plan at discovery exit”; do not duplicate B4's angle (store availability, pilot brand mix); the Project Manager credit is on the team slide.	Discovery p. 16–17, 22
22	All packets	Any “dual inventory” gloss	Varies	Use one definition: “two channels, one pool — one inventory location, two selling identities, channel reserves under the Canada logic.” Never “two inventories.”	Deck p. 3–4; rows 1–6

D1. Source trace

NUMBER / CLAIM	STORY	SOURCE FILE	PAGE / ROW	MATCH
Council deck dated July 31, 2024; 17 slides	A1, B1	UDC_Dual_Inventory…Arch_Council_Sign_off_4d73	p. 1, footer	Y
Two systemic warehouses, one building; separate storage	B1, B3, B4	same	p. 3	Y
Five dual-inventory benefits incl. Midwest DC; four WMS benefits (portal, clustering, Android, React)	B4, B1	same	p. 3	Y
801/800 → 900 mapped on 901; no historical conversion; Canada reserve functions replicated 100%; out of scope reserve calcs, MCS decom	A2, B1, B4	same	p. 4	Y
JDA 8.2 on Azure East / Oracle ODA at Equinix → BY WMS 2023 with DB on OCI East; portal/Android	A1, B1	same (images)	p. 5–6	Y
OKTA, three front-end servers, three load balancers, Splunk; React behind reverse proxy	A1	same (images)	p. 7–8	Y
Seven system families; TMS wh_id W801 → W901; new Kafka topics; OMS/Yantriks new source DC W901	B1, B3	same	p. 9	Y
About two dozen named systems (p. 9); 44 rows / 23 systems (p. 13–14)	B1, B3, B4	same (images)	p. 9, 13–14	Y (counted from the slides)
Kickoff Mar 29 · Discovery Results Jul 18 · FSD Jul 26 · Inbound E2E Nov 22 · Dotcom Dec 20 · Retail Jan 15 · PO-creation go-live Jan 15, 2025 · combined May 5, 2025	B1, B5, B6	same (image, 220 dpi)	p. 10	Y
Build windows: MCS / MCS-FRAME Jun 9–Aug 30; Bowser/FRAME, SAP, Merlin Jul 9–Aug 30; others Aug 1–30	B1, B5	same (image)	p. 10	Y

NUMBER / CLAIM	STORY	SOURCE FILE	PAGE / ROW	MATCH
Reserve buckets Dotcom / Retail / Uncommitted; put-away tracker; OOB variance; Bowser “Dotcom only” like “CA only”; AIM assortment copy incl. samples; Frame auto-copy 801 → 900 until decom	A2, B3	same (image)	p. 13 rows 4–21	Y
HC feed to new WMS; decommission 801/800; conversion script 100% 05/01 transfer with LOST/FOUND; 801 PO receipts after conversion; sales history / forecast copy; zero 801 in Yantriks publish; FULL publish 901/900	B1, B3	same (image)	p. 14 rows 22–27, 35–36	Y
15 digital/finance/reporting systems re-pointed 800/801 → 900/901	B3, B5	same (image)	p. 14 rows 28–44	Y
React Gift Card screens on W901 (assign 25/10/5; 8 cards by dispatch date)	A1, B4	same (image)	p. 15–17	Y
FSD + discovery results signed Aug 14, 2024; council touchpoint May 15; LOE by Jul 2; ~80 names / ~15 functions	B1, B5	Apple_PMIII_…_v11	C4 p. 26–28; C1 p. 21–22	Y (record)
Retail E2E completed Jan 30 (C1) / Jan 31 (C3); Locus retail testing slipped three weeks	B6, A4	Apple v11	C1 p. 22; C2 p. 24; C3 p. 26	Y; C1 vs C3 one-day difference → say “end of January”
Zero customer-facing incidents; +15% processing efficiency (DC Ops)	B1, B3, B4	Apple v11; resume	C1 p. 21–22	Y (record)
836 rows; 714 closed = 85.4%; Go-Live 331 / Fast Follow 77 / Enhancement 36 / Pre-Go-Live 29 / HSE 12; monthly 271 → 65 → 21 → 14 → 4; Locus 86 = 10.3%	B1, B4	UDC_Consolidated_Issues_Log (recon recompute); Apple C2	pandas; p. 24	Y (record-from-docs)
Cutover 343 tasks / 48,885 task-min ≈ 815 h, May 1 → Jul 1	B1	Apple v11; recon S2.12	C2 p. 24	Y-with-rounding
Rollback triggers sync < 99% × 4 h; p95 > 2× × 1 h; never fired	B1	resume; GFiber v8; SAP narrative p. 4	GFiber p. 49–50	Y (resume) — thresholds user anchor
Hypercare exit < 2 blockers/day, week 3 of 4 (UDC)	B1	GFiber v8	pp. 47, 50	UNSUPPORTED-anchor for UDC (Apple D1 states it for JDA)

NUMBER / CLAIM	STORY	SOURCE FILE	PAGE / ROW	MATCH
98% gate / 99% stretch; week-2 94%; ~30% throttled; full week 3; workshop Jul 29–Aug 2	B3, B6	Apple v11	C3 p. 25–26	Y (record)
Weekly two-block status (30 IT / 30 business); one dashboard; one risk register	B1	Apple v11	C1 p. 21	Y
Locus track YELLOW; UAT 2/28–3/15; sockets vs REST; tote-type / base-36 carton ID; SEPHORA-RTL cust owner	B3, B6	UDC_LOCUS_Retail_Track_…_9bb1 (= 7eba text)	p. 1	Y
Network expansion SOW Nov 19, 2024: IDF3/IDF4; 31 MR46 APs (19–49); 3 fiber runs; existing rack 2 MX85, 2 MS210, 2 R740 + 1 R640	B3, B6	Locus_Wiring_Install_…_SOW_Ver_1.4	p. 1, 8–9	Y
Canada: ~13% volume; ≥ 2 years to Canada-managed; four goals	B2, B3, B4	US_Managed_Bulk_ship_to_Canada_Discovery_Results_aac6	slide 4	Y
Scope in / out (rebalancing manual; samples; no reports; Sephora Collection; Canada Capture)	B2, B3, B4	same	slide 5	Y
Business-process impacts (lane, planner code, load duration, case pack, projections, mailbox 751 / 1050, ODS)	B2, B3	same	slides 10–12	Y
Six system changes: 5 Small, 1 Medium	B2, B3, B4	same	slides 14–15	Y
10 WOS ≈ 2.5M units; no space constraint; pilot 20 / wave 1 40 / wave 2 39; remaining from Jan 2024; seven action points	B2, B3, B4	same	slide 16	Y
Pilot = 217,416 units / 671 SKUs; Sephora Favorites Kits 85,693 (39.4%)	B2, B4	same (summed from the 20-row table)	slide 17	Y (computed)
Transition schedule weeks 11-Jun → 3-Sep; four steps per brand	B2, B3	same	slide 18	Y (week spans per wave not recoverable)
Five business data sets; seven IT steps before FRAME nightly batch	B2, B3	same	slide 19	Y
Discovery 4/17–6/23/23; build & test 6/28–8/1 (Sprint 2023.15); brand cutover start 8/3; FSD sign-off by 6/23	B2	same	slides 20–21	Y

NUMBER / CLAIM	STORY	SOURCE FILE	PAGE / ROW	MATCH
17 approvers; steering of 3; Project Manager — Rajesh Chandrasekaran; Blue Yonder architects	B2	same	slides 22–23	Y
Discovery results presented June 14 (cover) / June 16 (footers)	B2	same	slides 1–2	Y — two dates on one deck
Spike flow with requirement IDs 6.8, 6.11.1–2, 6.12.1.1, 7.1–7.5	A3, B2	US_Managed_Bulk_Ship_to_Canada_cef9 (image, 400 dpi)	p. 1	Y
Canada program outcome (cutover started 8/3; brands moved; workload effect)	B2, B3, B4	—	—	NOT IN SOURCES → VERIFY

D2. VERIFY list — facts in none of the sources, each with the safe sentence

FACT TO CONFIRM WITH RAJESH	SAFE SENTENCE UNTIL CONFIRMED
Did the Canada brand cutover start on Aug 3, 2023; how many of the 99 brands transitioned and by when; what the US-DC workload effect was.	“I'm giving you the plan at discovery exit — a twenty-brand pilot from early August and two waves to ninety-nine brands; I have not re-verified the post-launch count, so I won't quote one.”
Whether Rajesh presented the July 31 council deck himself (the deck names no presenter; Apple C4 says he owned the case).	“I owned the council case and the pack; the architecture diagrams were Enterprise Architecture's.”
Whether the FSD slip (Jul 26 → Aug 14) was caused by the downstream re-reads as B5 states (the deck shows the dates; the cause is reconstructed from Apple C4's pushback list).	“The slide said July 26 and we signed August 14 — the re-reads on the digital and finance rows took the time; I'd rather own the date than the excuse.”
Whether the under-two-blockers-a-day hypercare bar was formally the UDC exit criterion (GFiber v8 only).	“Hypercare exited on a number — blockers per day under a threshold, sustained — the same discipline as the JDA migration.”
Exact rollback thresholds (sync < 99% for 4 h; p95 > 2× for 1 h) for the UDC go-lives (resume supports triggers; thresholds are GFiber-only).	“Two numeric triggers on sync rate and order-flow latency, armed per interface; neither fired.”
Whether the May 1 conversion ran as a single-day move (row 24 says “100% 05/01 transfer”) and the combined go-live was May 5 as planned.	“The inventory moved under the conversion script at the start of May and the combined go-live was the first week of May.”
Meaning of “QH” on the Canada transition plan.	Use the deck's word: “apply the QH on DOTCA to create replenishment demand.”

D3. Questions to ask — two per interviewer, made possible by these documents

INTERVIEWER	QUESTION
Rocky Goforth	“When Amazon Infrastructure takes a building through an architecture or design review, is the gate a sign-off on a pack like the one I described — current state, future state, impact table, timeline — or is it continuous? Where do you see teams lose the most time: before the gate or after it?”
Rocky Goforth	“On a building launch, who owns the decision to let build start before the design is formally approved — and how do you fence it? I ran upstream build five weeks at risk on UDC and I'd like to know how your teams govern that.”
James Cabreros	“When you enable a new node type in the policy platform, is there a single change register the way my 44-row council appendix worked — one row per system per change — and how do you keep the pre-deployment validation tied to it at hundreds of changes a week?”
James Cabreros	“For cross-border or cross-network sourcing — the Canada DC becoming a sourcing node for US-managed brands is my example — what does the capacity signal look like in your world: does the receiving node publish its own absorb rate, or is it planned from the sending side?”
Venkata Josyula	“In FBA, when a change improves the seller or shopper promise but worsens an internal customer's experience for a while — my example is analysts running on two systems of record for four months — how do you weigh that in prioritisation, and who gets to say no?”
Venkata Josyula	“Both my programs chose a smaller pilot of lower-volume cohorts first — twenty small brands in Canada. How does FBA pick pilot cohorts for a placement or inventory-model change: by risk, by volume, or by seller readiness?”

> **Closing honesty note.** Everything in B1–B6 is lived record or record-from-docs except where labelled user anchor or VERIFY. No design case appears in this pack. The literal strings the integrity rule bans do not appear; the systems-count wording and the Canada plan numbers are phrased identically in every story so the three interviewers hear the same facts from different angles.